

SS 1 FASHION DESIGN AND GARMENT MAKING LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: INTRODUCTION TO FASHION & GARMENT MAKING



MEANING OF FASHION AND GARMENT MAKING

It is essential to understand that "fashion" and "garment making" are two related but distinct concepts.

- **FASHION:** Fashion is the **prevailing style or trend** in clothing, accessories, and even lifestyle, at a particular time and place. It is a social and cultural phenomenon.

- It reflects the "spirit of the times" (*zeitgeist*). For example, "power dressing" with shoulder pads in the 1980s reflected women's changing roles in the workplace.
- Fashion is about the *idea*, the *style*, the *aesthetic*, and the *look*.
- It is constantly **changing and evolving**. What is fashionable today may be outdated tomorrow.
- Fashion is a form of **non-verbal communication**; it tells people who you are (or who you want to be) without you speaking a word.
- **GARMENT MAKING (TAILORING/SEWING):** Garment Making is the **technical craft, skill, or process** of *creating* clothing. It is the practical application of design.
 - It involves all the steps from an idea to a finished product: pattern drafting, cutting, sewing, and finishing.
 - It is about *construction, fit, technique, and quality*.
 - While fashion (the *style*) changes quickly, the *skills* of garment making (like sewing a straight seam or setting a sleeve) are timeless.
 - You can be a skilled garment maker (a tailor) without being a fashion designer (a trendsetter).

In summary: Fashion is the "what" (the style). Garment Making is the "how" (the craft).

IMPORTANCE OF FASHION & GARMENT MAKING

The importance of clothing and its creation can be understood on two levels: for the individual and for the society/economy.

- **IMPORTANCE TO THE INDIVIDUAL:**
 - a. **Protection:** The most basic function. Clothing protects the body from weather (sun, rain, cold) and environmental hazards (insects, germs, injuries).
 - b. **Modesty:** Clothing covers the body according to the social, cultural, and religious norms of a society.
 - c. **Identification:** Clothing can immediately identify a person's role, profession, or status (e.g., a nurse's uniform, a king's regalia, a school uniform, a soldier's camouflage).

- d. **Self-Expression:** Fashion is a powerful tool for expressing one's personality, creativity, and mood.
- e. **Confidence & Self-Esteem:** A well-made, well-fitting garment that a person loves can significantly boost their confidence.
- **IMPORTANCE TO THE SOCIETY & ECONOMY:**
 - a. **Job Creation:** The fashion and garment industry is a massive global employer. It creates millions of jobs, from the cotton farmer to the factory worker, the fashion designer, the tailor, the marketer, and the retail staff.
 - b. **Economic Growth:** It is a multi-trillion-dollar industry. It contributes significantly to a nation's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) through manufacturing, sales, and exports. (In Nigeria, the "Ankara" and tailoring industry is a prime example of a massive, localized economy).
 - c. **Cultural Identity & Preservation:** Traditional attire (like the Nigerian *Agbada* or *Isiagu*) is a vital part of a nation's cultural heritage. The fashion industry helps to preserve these traditions and introduce them to the world.

CAREER OPPORTUNITIES

The fashion and garment industry is vast, with careers in four main sectors:

1. **DESIGN & CREATIVE:** (The "Idea" People)
 - **Fashion Designer:** Researches trends and creates original designs for clothing lines.
 - **Textile Designer:** Designs the *fabrics* themselves (the patterns, weaves, and prints, like *Adire* or *Ankara*).
 - **Fashion Illustrator:** Draws the designer's ideas (croquis and fashion flats).
 - **Costume Designer:** Designs and creates clothing for movies (Nollywood), theatre, and television.
2. **PRODUCTION & TECHNICAL:** (The "Skills" People)
 - **Pattern Maker/Drafter:** Creates the 2D "blueprint" (the pattern) from the designer's sketch. This is a highly skilled technical job.

- **Tailor/Seamstress:** A skilled artisan who constructs the garments. This is the core of "garment making."
- **Garment Technologist:** Works in a factory to ensure quality control, fit, and efficient production.
- **Embroiderer/Beader:** A specialist who adds decorative elements to garments (e.g., on *Agbada* or wedding gowns).

3. **MEDIA & MARKETING:** (The "Image" People)

- **Fashion Editor/Journalist:** Writes about fashion for magazines, newspapers, or blogs (e.g., BellaNaija Style).
- **Fashion Stylist:** Selects the clothing and accessories for photo shoots, celebrities, or clients.
- **Fashion Photographer:** Specializes in shooting clothing and models.
- **Fashion Blogger/Influencer:** Uses social media (like Instagram) to showcase trends and influence buyers.

4. **BUSINESS & RETAIL:** (The "Money" People)

- **Boutique Owner:** Opens and manages a store selling clothing.
- **Fashion Buyer:** Works for large stores to select and purchase the clothing that will be sold next season.
- **Visual Merchandiser:** Designs the shop windows and in-store displays to attract customers.

EVALUATION

1. In your own words, explain the main difference between "Fashion" and "Garment Making."
2. List the three most important functions of clothing for an individual.
3. Describe two major economic importances of the fashion industry in Nigeria.
4. What is the role of a "Pattern Maker"?
5. Differentiate between a "Fashion Designer" and a "Fashion Stylist."

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a 200-word essay on the topic: "How I Use Fashion to Express My Personality."
2. Interview a local tailor or seamstress in your neighborhood. Ask them (a) How they learned their skill, (b) What their biggest challenge is, and (c) What they enjoy most about their job. Write a one-page report on your findings.
3. Look at the career opportunities listed. Which of the four sectors (Design, Production, Media, Business) interests you the most, and why?
4. Define the following terms: Trend, Aesthetic, GDP, Pattern Drafting, Textile.
5. Find a picture of a Nigerian celebrity (e.g., from an awards show). In one paragraph, describe their outfit and what you think it communicates about them.



WEEK 2: HISTORY OF FASHION



EVOLUTION OF CLOTHING

The history of clothing is the history of humanity. It shows our progression from basic survival to complex social structures and self-expression.

- **PREHISTORIC (c. 100,000 - 5,000 BCE):**
 - **Materials:** Animal skins, furs, leaves, grasses.
 - **Purpose:** Purely functional. **Protection** from cold, sun, rain, and sharp objects.

- **Construction:** Draped or tied. The invention of the bone **needle** (c. 30,000 BCE) allowed for the first "sewn" garments of hide.
- **ANCIENT CIVILIZATIONS (c. 3,000 BCE - 400 CE):**
 - **Egypt:** Mastered **linen** (from the flax plant). Clothing was draped, simple, and light for the hot climate (e.g., *Kalasiris* for women, *Schenti* (loincloth) for men).
 - **Rome:** Clothing was a symbol of **status**. The **Toga** (a large, draped wool garment) was worn by male citizens. Non-citizens could not wear it. The *Stola* was the women's equivalent.
 - **Purpose:** Shifted from just protection to **status, identification, and modesty**.
- **MEDIEVAL PERIOD (c. 400 - 1400):**
 - Clothing became more fitted to the body. **Wool** was the dominant fabric, with linen for undergarments.
 - **Sumptuary Laws:** These were laws that controlled *who* could wear *what*. For example, only nobility might be allowed to wear purple or imported silk. Fashion was strictly regulated by class.
- **RENAISSANCE (c. 1400 - 1600):**
 - An "explosion" of art, science, and textiles. Clothing became extremely elaborate, decorative, and exaggerated (e.g., large ruffs, puffed sleeves, corsets) to show off wealth and power.
- **19TH CENTURY (1800s):**
 - **The Industrial Revolution:** The invention of the **power loom** and the **sewing machine** (by Elias Howe & Isaac Singer) changed *everything*.
 - **Mass Production:** For the first time, clothing could be made in factories, not just by hand. This led to "ready-to-wear" garments.
 - **Haute Couture:** In Paris, **Charles Frederick Worth** became the "father of haute couture." He was the first "fashion designer" to dictate styles and sew his name into his garments.
- **20TH CENTURY (1900s):** The fastest-changing century.

- **1920s:** "The Flapper." Women's styles became loose, boyish, with dropped waists and shorter hemlines (Coco Chanel).
- **1940s:** World War II. "Utility" clothing. Fabrics were rationed. Styles were simple and military-inspired.
- **1950s:** Christian Dior's "New Look." After the war, fashion became feminine again—tiny waists, full skirts.
- **1960s:** The "Youthquake." For the first time, fashion was driven by young people, not the rich. The **miniskirt** (by Mary Quant) was a symbol of rebellion.
- **1980s:** "Power Dressing." Women in the workplace wore suits with large **shoulder pads** to look more powerful.
- **1990s:** "Grunge" and "Minimalism." A backlash against the 80s, with casual, anti-fashion looks (flannel shirts, simple dresses).

NIGERIAN TRADITIONAL ATTIRE

Nigeria's fashion history is rich and diverse, reflecting its hundreds of ethnic groups. The attire is not just clothing; it is a symbol of identity, tribe, marital status, and occasion.

• YORUBA ATTIRE:

- **Fabric:** Famous for **Aso-Oke** (a hand-woven, often striped, "prestige cloth") and **Adire** (indigo-dyed "tie-dye" or batik fabric).
- **Men:** A four-piece set.
 - i. **Sokoto (Sho-ko-to):** Loose-fitting trousers.
 - ii. **Buba (Boo-ba):** A loose-fitting shirt.
 - iii. **Agbada (Ag-ba-da):** A very large, heavily embroidered "grand-boubou" or robe worn over the top.
 - iv. **Fila (Fee-la):** The cap, which can be tall (*Gobi*) or folded (*Abeti-aja*).
- **Women:** A five-piece set.
 - i. **Iro (Ee-ro):** A large rectangular wrapper tied at the waist.
 - ii. **Buba (Boo-ba):** A loose-fitting blouse.

- iii. **Gele (Geh-leh):** The elaborate, starched head-tie.
- iv. **Ipele (Ee-peh-leh):** A shawl or scarf draped over one shoulder.
- v. **Iborun (Ee-bo-run):** A veil, less common today.

- **IGBO ATTIRE:**

- **Fabric:** Famous for **Akwaete**, a hand-woven fabric with intricate motifs, and **Ukara** (a blue-and-white ritual cloth).
- **Men:**
 - i. **Isiagu (Ee-see-ah-goo):** The "Lion's Head" shirt. A patterned, often black, velvet or cotton shirt, symbolizing power and chieftaincy.
 - ii. **Wrapper (Ogodo):** A wrapper tied around the waist.
 - iii. **Okpu (Hat):** A red cap (*Okpu-nze*) indicates a titled man.
- **Women:**
 - i. **Blouse:** A fitted, often lace or embroidered blouse.
 - ii. **Wrappers:** Traditionally *two* wrappers (one worn over the other).
 - iii. **Ichafu (Ee-cha-foo):** The head-tie (similar to *Gele*).
 - iv. **Accessories:** Extravagant use of **coral beads** and **ivory** (or bone) to show status.

- **HAUSA-FULANI ATTIRE:**

- **Fabric:** Often cotton (Guinea Brocade) with intricate, symbolic **embroidery** in contrasting thread.
- **Men:**
 - i. **Babban Riga (Bab-ban Ree-ga):** The Hausa equivalent of the *Agbada*, a very large, voluminous robe, often with striking embroidery.
 - ii. **Wando (Wan-do):** Trousers.
 - iii. **Zanna (or Fula):** The distinctive, tall, embroidered cap.
- **Women:**
 - i. **Zani:** A large wrapper.
 - ii. **Blouse & Shawl:** A blouse and matching shawl.

- iii. **Mayafi or Hijab:** A veil or head-covering, reflecting the strong influence of Islamic culture.

EVALUATION

1. What was the "Industrial Revolution," and how did it change clothing production?
2. Who is Charles Frederick Worth, and why is he called the "father of haute couture"?
3. Describe the four main garments that make up a man's complete Yoruba *Agbada* set.
4. What is an *Isiagu*, and which ethnic group is it associated with?
5. What are the key differences between Yoruba *Aso-Oke* and Igbo *Akwaete* fabrics?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Choose one 20th-century decade (e.g., 1920s, 1960s, 1980s). Write a 200-word report on the major fashion trends of that decade and what they represented in society.
2. Draw and label the complete traditional attire for either a Yoruba woman OR an Igbo man.
3. Find a picture of a modern Nigerian fashion design that is *influenced* by traditional attire (e.g., a modern *Agbada* for women, an *Ankara* suit). In one paragraph, describe how it is both traditional and modern.
4. Define the following terms: Sumptuary Laws, Haute Couture, Ready-to-Wear, *Gele*, *Babban Riga*.
5. Interview an older relative (a grandparent or parent). Ask them to describe the "fashion" that was popular when they were in secondary school. Write a one-page report on your findings.

WEEK 3: BASIC SEWING TOOLS & EQUIPMENT I

INTRODUCTION

A craftsperson is nothing without their tools. In garment making, using the *correct* tool for the *correct* job is the difference between a professional-looking garment and an amateurish mess.

We classify these tools by their function. This week, we focus on **Cutting, Measuring, and Pressing** tools.



1. CUTTING TOOLS

These are all the tools used to cut fabric, paper, and thread.

- **DRESSMAKER'S SHEARS (FABRIC SHEARS):**
 - **Description:** A large (8-10 inch) tool with a "bent" handle. This bent handle allows the shears to rest flat on the table while cutting, which is essential for accuracy.
 - **Function:** Used *ONLY* for cutting fabric.
 - **Care:** Never use on paper (it dulls the blade). Keep dry.
- **PINKING SHEARS:**
 - **Description:** Shears with a zigzag or sawtooth blade.
 - **Function:** Used to create a "pinking" finish on a seam allowance. This **prevents fraying** on woven fabrics.
 - **Care:** Also for fabric only.
- **SCISSORS (GENERAL PURPOSE):**
 - **Description:** Smaller (4-6 inch) with symmetrical, straight handles.
 - **Function:** Used for all-purpose tasks like cutting paper patterns, trimming, and other crafts. *Never* use your good fabric shears for this.
- **THREAD CLIPPER (SNIPS):**
 - **Description:** A small, spring-loaded tool, held in the palm.
 - **Function:** Used for snipping threads at the sewing machine. It is fast and convenient.
- **SEAM RIPPER:**
 - **Description:** A small tool with a hook-like blade and a safety point.
 - **Function:** The most important tool for fixing mistakes. It is used to carefully **unpick and remove stitches** without tearing the fabric.
- **ROTARY CUTTER:**
 - **Description:** A tool that looks like a pizza cutter, with a very sharp, round blade.
 - **Function:** Used with a ruler and a special "self-healing" mat to cut fabric (especially for quilting).

2. MEASURING TOOLS

These tools are essential for accuracy. "Measure twice, cut once" is the golden rule.

- **TAPE MEASURE:**

- **Description:** A 60-inch (150 cm) flexible tape made of plastic or fiberglass.
- **Function:** The most important measuring tool. Used for **taking body measurements** (bust, waist, hip) and for measuring fabric.
- **Care:** Do not let it stretch or crack.

- **RULER / METER STICK:**

- **Description:** A 1-meter (or 1-yard) rigid, straight stick.
- **Function:** Used for drawing long, straight lines on patterns or fabric (e.g., grainlines, hems).

- **TAILOR'S SQUARE (L-SQUARE):**

- **Description:** A large, L-shaped ruler.
- **Function:** Essential for **pattern drafting**. It helps create perfect 90-degree (perpendicular) lines, which are the foundation of all patterns.

- **FRENCH CURVE:**

- **Description:** A plastic tool with multiple, complex curves.
- **Function:** Used for drafting smooth, curved lines that match the body, such as **armholes, necklines, and hiplines**.

- **SEAM GAUGE:**

- **Description:** A small, 6-inch metal ruler with a sliding marker.
- **Function:** Used for measuring small, precise distances quickly and repeatedly, such as **seam allowances, hem widths**, and buttonhole placement.

3. PRESSING TOOLS

"Pressing" is *not* the same as "ironing." Ironing is sliding the iron back and forth to remove wrinkles. **Pressing** is the professional technique of lifting and placing the iron down firmly to *set* seams and *shape* the garment during construction.

- **ELECTRIC IRON (STEAM/DRY):**
 - **Description:** The primary tool for applying heat and steam.
 - **Function:** To press seams flat, fuse interfacing, and give a crisp, professional finish to the garment.
- **IRONING BOARD:**
 - **Description:** A long, narrow, padded, heat-resistant surface.
 - **Function:** Provides the flat surface for pressing.
- **TAILOR'S HAM (OR DRESSMAKER'S HAM):**
 - **Description:** A firmly packed, ham-shaped cushion.
 - **Function:** A "curved ironing board." It is used to press curved areas of a garment, such as **darts, bustlines, and hips**, to maintain their 3D shape.
- **SEAM ROLL (OR SAUSAGE):**
 - **Description:** A long, firmly packed tube.
 - **Function:** Used for pressing long, tubular seams (like a sleeve seam) *open* without the seam allowance leaving a mark on the outside of the fabric.
- **PRESS CLOTH:**
 - **Description:** A lightweight cotton or organza cloth.
 - **Function:** Placed *between* the iron and the fashion fabric. It **protects the fabric** from scorching, shining, or water spots. Essential for delicate fabrics like silk or wool.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main physical difference between Dressmaker's Shears and general-purpose Scissors, and what is the rule for using shears?
2. What is the function of a Seam Ripper?
3. Name two measuring tools used specifically for pattern drafting, and state their function.
4. What is the difference between "Ironing" and "Pressing"?
5. What is a Tailor's Ham used for?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Tool Inventory:** Go through your home and find 5 of the tools listed this week (e.g., tape measure, iron, scissors). Write down their name, their condition, and their function.
2. Draw a simple sketch of a **Tailor's Square**, a **French Curve**, and a **Seam Gauge**.
3. Write a 200-word essay on the topic: "Why 'Measure Twice, Cut Once' is the Most Important Rule in Garment Making."
4. What is the purpose of a "Press Cloth"? Find a scrap of fabric at home and demonstrate (with supervision) how to use a press cloth.
5. Define the following terms: Fraying, Seam Allowance, Pattern Drafting, Grainline, Dart.



WEEK 4: BASIC SEWING TOOLS & EQUIPMENT II

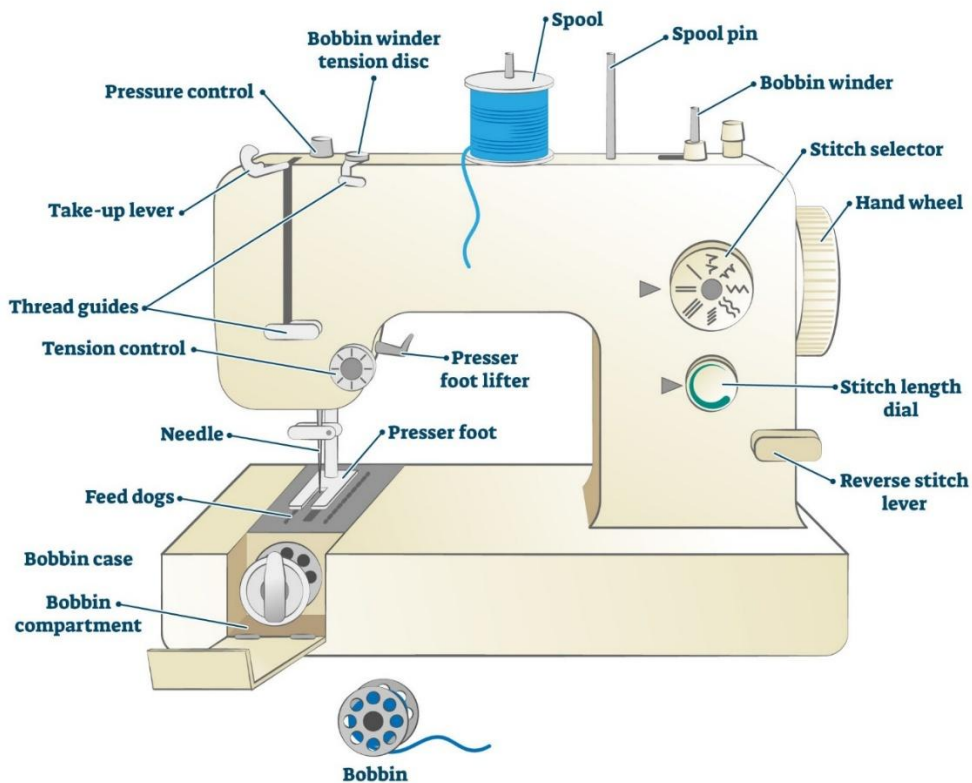
TOPIC: THE SEWING MACHINE

INTRODUCTION

The sewing machine is the most important and complex piece of equipment in garment making. It uses two threads (an upper/needle thread and a lower/bobbin thread) to create a **lockstitch**, which is a strong, secure stitch that will not unravel.

Understanding its parts and functions is essential for using it, and *maintaining* it is essential for professional results. We will discuss the parts of a standard **Domestic Electric Sewing Machine**.

SEWING MACHINE



PARTS OF THE SEWING MACHINE & THEIR FUNCTIONS

We can group the parts by their purpose:

1. MAIN FRAME & MOVEMENT

- **Head:** The entire top part of the machine, containing all the mechanisms.
- **Arm:** The curved part of the head that extends over the work area.
- **Bed:** The flat, lower part of the machine where the fabric rests.
- **Hand Wheel (Balance Wheel):** The large wheel on the right side.
 - **Function:** Used to *manually* raise or lower the needle, one stitch at a time. *Always* turn it **towards you**.
- **Foot Pedal (Controller):** The electric pedal placed on the floor.
 - **Function:** Acts as the "accelerator." Pressing it makes the machine sew.

2. THREADING & TENSION SYSTEM (UPPER THREAD)

- **Spool Pin:** The peg (vertical or horizontal) at the top that holds the spool of thread.
- **Thread Guides:** A series of hooks and loops that guide the thread from the spool to the needle.
- **Tension Discs & Regulator:** Two small discs that the thread passes between. The **Tension Regulator** (a numbered dial) squeezes these discs together.
 - **Function:** This is the most important adjustment. It controls the **tightness** of the *upper thread*. (If the dial is on "9," the thread is very tight; on "1," it is very loose).
- **Thread Take-up Lever:** The metal hook that moves up and down in a slot on the front of the machine.
 - **Function:** It pulls the thread from the spool, feeds it to the needle, and "locks" the stitch. **The needle *must* be threaded with the take-up lever at its *highest* position.**

3. STITCH FORMATION SYSTEM (NEEDLE & BOBBIN)

- **Needle:** The special sewing machine needle with the eye at the *point*.
- **Needle Clamp:** The screw that holds the needle in place.
- **Presser Foot:** The small, ski-shaped foot that rests on the fabric.

- **Function:** It holds the fabric down *firmly* against the feed dog.
- **Presser Foot Lifter:** The lever (usually at the back) that raises and lowers the presser foot.
- **Throat Plate (Needle Plate):** The flat metal plate under the needle with lines (seam guides) and a hole for the needle.
- **Feed Dog (Feed Teeth):** The set of "teeth" under the presser foot that *move* up, back, and down.
 - **Function:** This is what **pulls the fabric** through the machine.
- **Bobbin:** A small spool that holds the *lower thread*.
- **Bobbin Case:** The metal case that holds the bobbin in place under the bed.
- **Bobbin Winder:** A mechanism (usually on top) for rapidly winding thread from the large spool onto the bobbin.

4. STITCH CONTROL SYSTEM

- **Stitch Regulator (Stitch Length Dial):**
 - **Function:** Controls the *length* of each stitch (e.g., "1" is a tiny stitch, "4" is a long stitch).
- **Stitch Selector Dial:**
 - **Function:** Chooses the *type* of stitch (e.g., straight stitch, zigzag, buttonhole).
- **Reverse Lever (Backstitch Button):**
 - **Function:** Makes the machine sew *backwards*. Used at the *beginning* and *end* of a seam to "lock" the stitches so they do not unravel.

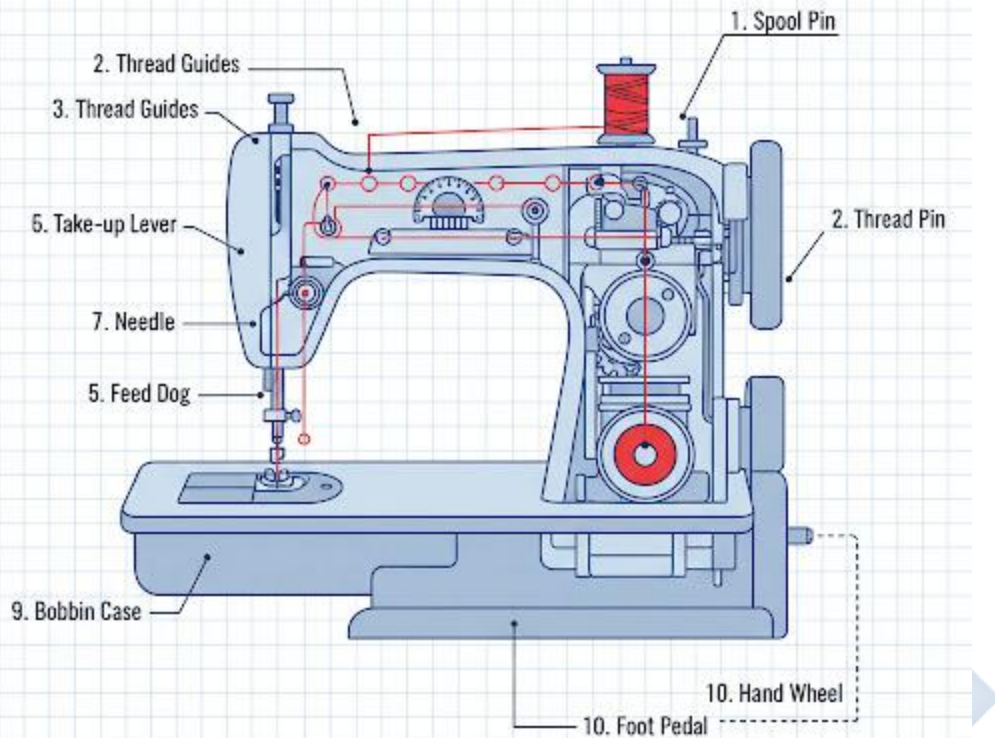
MAINTENANCE OF THE SEWING MACHINE

A sewing machine is a precision instrument. A poorly maintained machine will produce poor stitches, skip stitches, or break threads.

- **CLEANING (REGULARLY):**
 - The biggest enemy is **lint** (fabric dust and thread fibers).

- **Action:** Switch off and unplug the machine. Remove the throat plate and bobbin case.
- Use a small **lint brush** to clean all the fibers from the feed dog and bobbin area.
- Wipe down the exterior of the machine.
- **OILING (PERIODICALLY):**
 - **Action:** Use only **sewing machine oil** (a clear, thin oil).
 - Place *one drop* of oil on all moving metal parts, as specified in the machine's manual.
 - Run the machine for a few seconds *without thread* to spread the oil.
- **NEEDLE CHANGING (FREQUENTLY):**
 - A needle is *not* permanent. It becomes blunt after 6-8 hours of sewing.
 - **Action:** Change the needle regularly. A **blunt, bent, or damaged needle** is the #1 cause of skipped stitches, fabric puckering, and thread breaking.
 - Use the correct *type* of needle for the fabric (e.g., "Jeans" needle for denim, "Ballpoint" for stretch fabric).
- **GENERAL CARE:**
 - Cover the machine when not in use to protect it from dust.
 - Do not sew over pins (this can break the needle and damage the machine).
 - Do not "pull" the fabric from the back; let the feed dog do the work.

BASIC SEWING TOOLS & EQUIPMENT II (THE SEWING MACHINE)



EVALUATION

1. What is the function of the "Feed Dog"?
2. What is the difference between the "Hand Wheel" and the "Foot Pedal"?
3. What is the "Tension Regulator," and what happens if the tension is set too high (too tight)?
4. What is the purpose of the "Reverse Lever"?
5. List three essential maintenance steps for a sewing machine.

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Sit at a sewing machine (at home or school). *Do not plug it in or thread it.*
 - (a) Identify 10 of the parts listed in the notes.

- (b) Practice raising and lowering the presser foot.
 - (c) Practice turning the hand wheel *towards you* to make the needle go up and down.
 - (d) Practice inserting and removing the bobbin.
2. Draw a large, clear diagram of a sewing machine and label at least 15 parts.
 3. Write a 200-word report explaining *why* a blunt needle is the cause of so many sewing problems.
 4. What is a "lockstitch"? Draw a simple diagram showing how the upper (needle) thread and lower (bobbin) thread "lock" together.
 5. Define the following terms: Lint, Bobbin, Tension, Feed Dog, Zigzag Stitch.



WEEK 6: SAFETY IN THE SEWING WORKSHOP



INTRODUCTION

A sewing workshop (or "fashion lab") is a place of work filled with tools that can be dangerous if misused. Safety is the #1 priority. A safe workshop is a clean, organized, and professional workshop.

Safety is the practice of preventing accidents by following rules and being aware of your surroundings.

GENERAL SAFETY RULES & ACCIDENT PREVENTION

1. PERSONAL CONDUCT:

- **No running**, playing, or "horseplay" in the workshop.
- **Concentrate**: Pay full attention to your task, especially when using sharp tools or the sewing machine.
- **Attire**: Tie back long hair. Do not wear loose, dangling jewelry or floppy sleeves that could get caught in the machine.
- **Food & Drink**: Keep all food and drinks away from the sewing machines and cutting tables.

2. WORKSPACE MANAGEMENT:

- **Cleanliness**: Keep your work area clean and tidy. Put scraps in the bin.
- **Clear Floors**: Keep the floor clear of bags, scraps, and electrical cords to prevent trips.
- **Put Tools Away**: When you are finished with a tool (e.g., shears, seam ripper), put it back in its proper place.

SPECIFIC SAFETY RULES BY TOOL

1. CUTTING TOOLS (SHEARS, ROTARY CUTTERS, SEAM RIPPERS)

- **Handling**: Always pass sharp tools (like shears) **handle-first** to the other person.
- **Cutting**: Keep your free hand (the one holding the fabric) *away* from the cutting line.
- **Storage**: Keep shears and scissors *closed* when not in use. Keep seam rippers capped.
- **Pins**: **Never** cut or sew over pins. Remove them as you approach. Cutting a pin can destroy your shears; sewing over one can break your needle and send shrapnel flying.

2. SEWING MACHINE

- **Focus**: Keep your eyes and fingers *away* from the needle area while sewing.
- **Power OFF**: Always **turn the power off** (or unplug) the machine when:
 - Threading the needle.
 - Changing the needle.

- Cleaning the bobbin area.
- **Fabric:** Do *not* pull the fabric from the back. Let the feed dog do the work. Pulling can bend or break the needle.
- **Electrical:** Ensure the foot pedal cord is not a tripping hazard.

3. *PRESSING TOOLS (IRON)*

- **Heat:** The iron is **extremely hot**. Never touch the soleplate to check. Assume it is *always* hot.
- **Position:** Always rest the iron on its **HEEL**, never flat on its soleplate (this is a fire hazard).
- **Steam:** Be aware of hot steam, which can cause severe scalds. Keep your face and hands away from the steam vents.
- **Power OFF:** Always **switch off and unplug** the iron when you are finished or walk away.
- **Water:** Use the correct type of water (often distilled) and do not overfill.

4. *ELECTRICAL SAFETY*

- Ensure all electrical cords are in good condition (no frayed or exposed wires).
- Ensure your hands are **dry** before touching any plug, socket, or switch.
- Unplug equipment by pulling the **plug**, not the **cord**.

FIRST AID IN THE SEWING WORKSHOP

Accidents can happen even in a safe workshop. You must know what to do.

- **THE FIRST AID BOX:** Every workshop must have a clearly marked First Aid Box containing:
 - Adhesive plasters (Band-Aids)
 - Sterile gauze pads
 - Antiseptic wipes
 - Bandages

- Burn cream or gel
- Medical tape
- Small scissors
- **TREATING COMMON ACCIDENTS:**
 - a. **MINOR CUTS (from Shears or Seam Ripper):**
 - **Action:** Apply firm, direct pressure with a clean cloth to stop the bleeding.
 - Wash the cut with soap and cool water.
 - Apply an antiseptic wipe and cover with a sterile plaster.
 - b. **PUNCTURES (from Needle or Pin):**
 - **Action:** Encourage the wound to bleed slightly to flush out germs.
 - Wash thoroughly and apply a plaster.
 - *If a needle breaks off in the skin, do not dig for it. See a medical professional.*
 - c. **BURNS (from Iron):**
 - **Action:** Immediately run the affected area under **cool (not ice-cold) running water** for at least 10-15 minutes. This draws the heat out.
 - Cover *loosely* with a sterile gauze pad. *Do not* apply oil, Vaseline, or pomade.
 - d. **ELECTRIC SHOCK (from Machine):**
 - **Action: DO NOT TOUCH THE PERSON.**
 - Immediately **switch off the power** at the main socket or breaker.
 - Once the power is off, check if the person is responsive and breathing. Call for professional help.

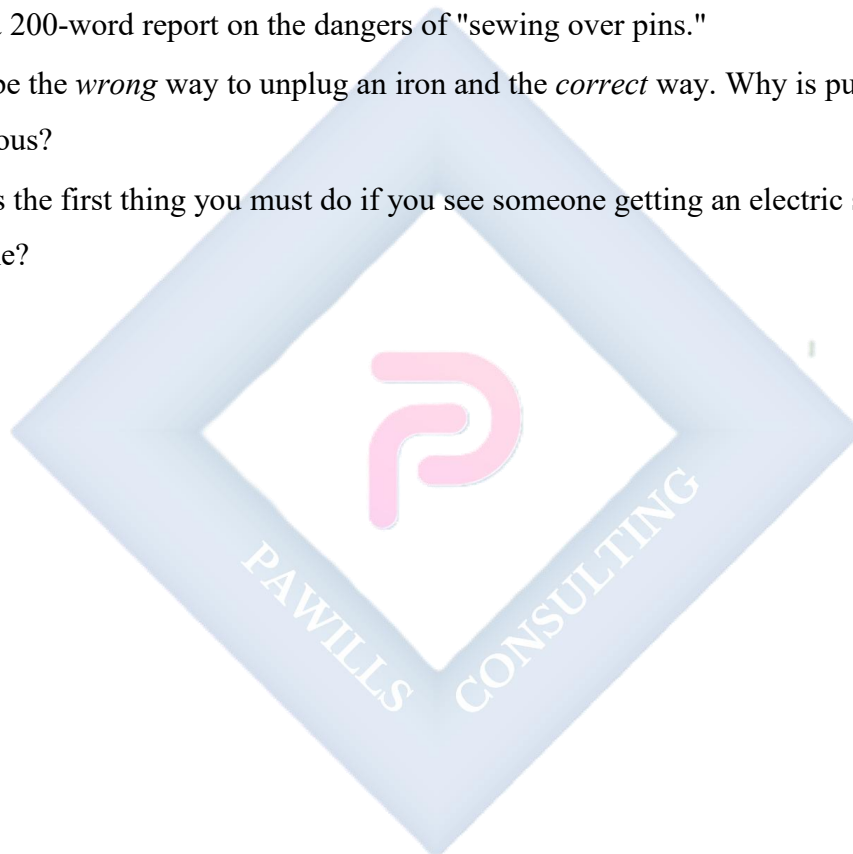
EVALUATION

1. List three general safety rules for conduct in the workshop.
2. What is the correct way to pass a pair of shears to someone?
3. When must you turn the sewing machine's power off? (List 3 instances).

4. What is the correct "at rest" position for an iron, and why?
5. What is the *first* and most important step in treating a burn from an iron?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Create a "Workshop Safety" poster. Your poster must have at least 10 "Dos and Don'ts" for sewing safely.
2. Go to your home (or school's) First Aid box. Make a list of its contents. Is anything missing, based on the lesson?
3. Write a 200-word report on the dangers of "sewing over pins."
4. Describe the *wrong* way to unplug an iron and the *correct* way. Why is pulling the cord dangerous?
5. What is the first thing you must do if you see someone getting an electric shock from a machine?

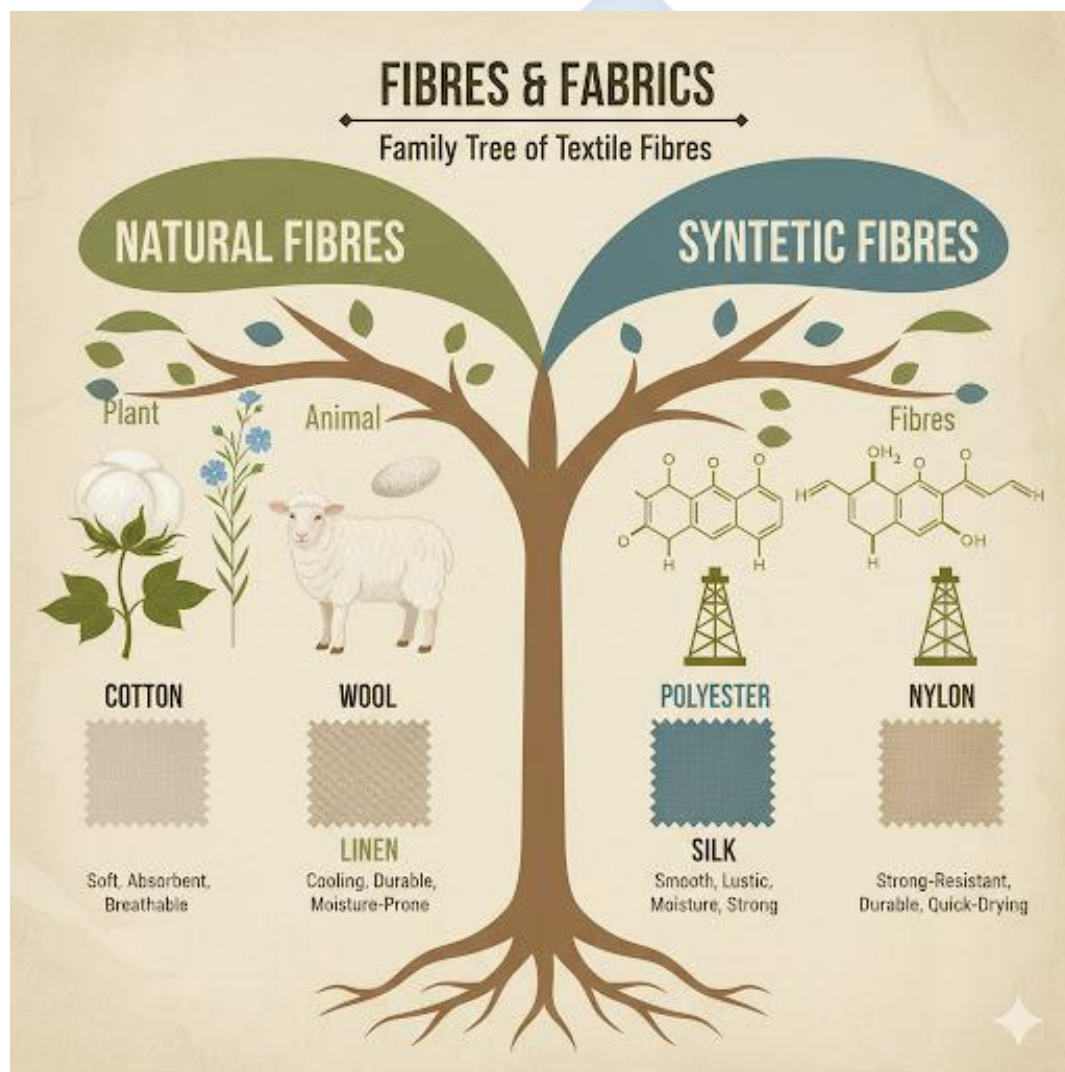


WEEK 8: FIBRES & FABRICS I

INTRODUCTION

To select the right fabric for a garment, you must first understand its "DNA." The **fibre** is the basic "building block" of all fabric. It is the small, hair-like strand that is spun into **yarn** (thread), which is then **woven** or **knitted** into **fabric** (cloth).

The *type* of fibre determines the fabric's characteristics: how it feels, how it behaves, how it reacts to heat, and how it should be cared for.



CLASSIFICATION OF TEXTILE FIBRES

All fibres fall into two main categories: **Natural** or **Synthetic (Man-Made)**.

1. NATURAL FIBRES

These are fibres that come from **plant or animal** sources.

- **A. PLANT (VEGETABLE) FIBRES:** These are **Cellulosic** (made of cellulose).
 - **COTTON:**
 - **Source:** The soft, fluffy "boll" (seed pod) of the cotton plant.
 - **Characteristics:**
 - **Pros:** Very **absorbent** (comfortable in hot, humid weather like Nigeria's), **strong** when wet, washable, soft.
 - **Cons:** **Wrinkles badly**, can shrink, burns easily.
 - **LINEN:**
 - **Source:** The woody stem of the **flax plant**.
 - **Characteristics:**
 - **Pros:** **Extremely strong** (strongest natural fibre), very **absorbent** and cool to the wear (dries fast), has a unique "slub" texture.
 - **Cons:** **Wrinkles extremely badly** (seen as a mark of quality), expensive.
- **B. ANIMAL FIBRES:** These are **Protein** fibres.
 - **WOOL:**
 - **Source:** The fleece (coat) of sheep.
 - **Characteristics:**
 - **Pros:** Very **warm** (traps air), **elastic** (stretches and returns to shape), very absorbent, does not wrinkle easily.
 - **Cons:** **Shrinks (felts)** with heat and agitation, can be itchy, must be washed carefully or dry-cleaned.
 - **SILK:**

- **Source:** The "cocoon" of the **silkworm**. The silkworm spins one continuous filament.
- **Characteristics:**
 - **Pros:** Very **strong**, beautiful **luster** (shine), smooth, drapes beautifully, insulating (warm in winter, cool in summer).
 - **Cons:** Expensive, can be damaged by sunlight and bleach, often requires dry-cleaning.

2. SYNTHETIC / MAN-MADE FIBRES

These are fibres manufactured through chemical processes.

- **A. REGENERATED FIBRES:** These are made from a *natural source* (like wood pulp) that is *chemically processed*.
 - **RAYON (VISCOSE):**
 - **Source:** Wood pulp, chemically dissolved and "regenerated" into a fibre.
 - **Characteristics:** (Designed as "artificial silk").
 - **Pros:** Soft, drapes beautifully, very absorbent, comfortable.
 - **Cons:** **Very weak when wet**, wrinkles easily.
- **B. SYNTHETIC FIBRES:** These are made *entirely* from chemical synthesis, usually **petrochemicals** (oil and coal).
 - **POLYESTER (PET):**
 - **Source:** Petrochemicals.
 - **Characteristics:** (The "workhorse" of modern fashion).
 - **Pros:** **Excellent wrinkle resistance**, very durable, strong, holds its shape.
 - **Cons:** **Hydrophobic** (does *not* absorb water, can feel hot and clammy), **heat-sensitive** (melts under a hot iron), holds oily stains.
 - **NYLON (POLYAMIDE):**
 - **Source:** Petrochemicals.

- **Characteristics:**
 - **Pros:** **Extremely strong**, very elastic, lustrous, resists abrasion.
 - **Cons:** Heat-sensitive (melts), yellows with age.
 - **Uses:** Stockings (hosiery), ropes, sportswear.
- **ACRYLIC:**
 - **Source:** Petrochemicals.
 - **Characteristics:** (Designed as "artificial wool").
 - **Pros:** Lightweight, soft, warm, washable, resistant to moths.
 - **Cons:** Can "pill" (form little balls), heat-sensitive.
 - **Uses:** Sweaters, blankets.

EVALUATION

1. What is the difference between a "fibre" and "yarn"?
2. What are the two main classifications of *natural* fibres? Give one example of each.
3. What is the main source of *synthetic* fibres like polyester?
4. Compare and contrast Cotton and Polyester. List one advantage of Cotton and one advantage of Polyester.
5. Why is Linen considered a "luxury" fabric, even though it wrinkles?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Fibre Hunt:** Look at the care labels on 5 different garments in your wardrobe.
 - (a) List the garments (e.g., "School Shirt," "P.E. Shorts," "Church dress").
 - (b) Write down the fibre content for each (e.g., "60% Cotton, 40% Polyester").
2. Write a 200-word essay explaining the difference between "Natural Fibres" and "Synthetic Fibres."
3. Why is Wool *not* a good fabric choice for regular clothing in Nigeria?
4. What is "Rayon," and why is it called a "regenerated" fibre, not a "natural" or "synthetic" one?
5. Define: Cellulosic, Protein, Hydrophobic, Lustre, Pilling.



WEEK 9: FIBRES & FABRICS II

TOPIC: FABRIC SELECTION FOR DIFFERENT GARMENTS

INTRODUCTION

Choosing the right fabric is the *most important decision* a designer makes after the sketch. The wrong fabric can ruin a brilliant design. A garment that is *intended* to be soft and flowing will fail if made from a stiff fabric. A garment that needs to be *structured* will fail if made from a soft fabric.

The choice of fabric is a balance between **look, feel, function, and cost.**



FACTORS TO CONSIDER IN FABRIC SELECTION

1. END USE / FUNCTION:

- What is this garment for? Is it for work, sports, or a special occasion?
- *Example:* Sportswear needs **stretch** and **wicking** (moisture-moving) properties (Polyester/Spandex). A work suit needs **durability** and **wrinkle resistance** (Wool or a Poly-Wool blend).

2. AESTHETICS (THE "LOOK"):

- **Drape:** How does the fabric hang? Does it *flow* (like Silk, Chiffon) or is it *stiff* (like Brocade, Aso-Oke)?
- **Lustre:** Is it shiny (Satin) or matte (Cotton)?
- **Texture:** Is it smooth (Silk) or rough (Linen, Burlap)?
- **Color/Pattern:** Does the fabric's design suit the garment's style?

3. COMFORT:

- **Absorbency:** Will it absorb sweat and feel comfortable in the heat? (Cotton, Linen) or will it feel clammy? (Polyester).
- **Softness:** Is it soft against the skin (Cotton, Silk) or itchy (some Wool)?
- **Weight:** Is it heavy (Brocade, Velvet) or light (Chiffon)?

4. DURABILITY:

- How strong is the fabric? Will it tear easily (Rayon) or last for years (Denim/Cotton)?
- Will it "pill" (Acrylic) or snag (Satin)?

5. CARE & MAINTENANCE:

- How must the garment be cleaned? Can it be machine-washed (Cotton, Polyester) or is it **Dry-Clean Only** (Silk, Wool, Velvet)?
- This is a critical factor for the customer. A "washable" uniform is practical; a "dry-clean only" uniform is not.

6. SEW-ABILITY:

- How easy is it to sew?
- *Easy*: Cotton, Linen (stable, don't stretch).
- *Difficult*: Silk, Chiffon (very slippery), Stretch Velvet (slips and stretches).

7. COST:

- Does the fabric fit the budget for the project?

EXAMPLES OF FABRIC SELECTION FOR GARMENTS

- **GARMENT: School Uniform (Shirt & Trousers)**
 - **Requirements:** Durable, washable, comfortable, wrinkle-resistant, affordable.
 - **Best Choice: Polyester/Cotton Blend (Poly-Cotton).**
 - **Why:** It has the "best of both worlds": the **comfort** and absorbency of Cotton, mixed with the **durability**, stain resistance, and **wrinkle resistance** of Polyester.
- **GARMENT: Nigerian Traditional Attire (*Agbada*, *Babban Riga*, formal *Iro*)**
 - **Requirements:** Must have "body" (stiffness), look expensive, show status, and hold embroidery well.
 - **Best Choice: Guinea Brocade, Aso-Oke, Damask, heavy polished Cotton, Lace.**
 - **Why:** These fabrics are stiff and structural. A soft, drapey fabric like chiffon would not work for an *Agbada* that needs to "stand."
- **GARMENT: Formal Evening Gown**
 - **Requirements:** Beautiful *drape*, high *lustre* (shine), "special occasion" feel.
 - **Best Choice: Satin, Silk, Chiffon (for overlays), Velvet.**
 - **Why:** These fabrics flow over the body and catch the light beautifully, creating a look of luxury.
- **GARMENT: Sportswear (P.E. Shorts, Jersey)**
 - **Requirements:** Must **stretch**, be strong, and **wick** moisture (move sweat *away* from the skin to evaporate).

- **Best Choice: Polyester, Nylon, Spandex (Lycra) Blends.**
- **Why:** Cotton is a *bad* choice because it *absorbs* sweat, becoming heavy, wet, and cold. Polyester *wicks* the sweat, keeping the athlete dry.
- **GARMENT: Baby Clothes**
 - **Requirements:** Very **soft**, **absorbent**, **hypoallergenic**, and **highly washable**.
 - **Best Choice: 100% Cotton (Jersey knit or Flannel).**
 - **Why:** A baby's skin is sensitive. Cotton is natural, soft, and can be washed in hot water to sanitize it.

EVALUATION

1. List five key factors a designer must consider when selecting a fabric.
2. What is "Drape," and why is it important for an evening gown?
3. What is "Wicking," and why is it important for sportswear?
4. Why is a "Polyester/Cotton blend" the best choice for a school uniform?
5. What fabric would be the *worst* choice for a traditional *Agbada*, and why?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Go to a fabric market or store (or look at fabric scraps at home). Find two fabrics: one that is **stiff** and one that **drapes** (flows).
 - (a) Name them (if you can, e.g., "Ankara" vs. "Chiffon").
 - (b) List a garment that would be perfect for the stiff fabric.
 - (c) List a garment that would be perfect for the drapey fabric.
2. Write a 200-word essay explaining why "Care & Maintenance" (e.g., washability) is a critical factor to consider when choosing a fabric for a customer.
3. Make a list of 3 different garments. For each one, state the *best* fabric choice and the *worst* fabric choice, and explain why.
4. Why is 100% Cotton a *bad* choice for P.E. shorts?
5. Define: Drape, Lustre, Wicking, Blend, Hypoallergenic.

WEEK 10: TEXTILE CARE & FINISHES

INTRODUCTION

This week, we cover two related topics:

1. **Textile Care:** The *maintenance* and cleaning of fabrics, which the *customer* does.
2. **Textile Finishes:** The *industrial processes* applied to fabrics *after* they are made, to change their look, feel, or performance.



PART 1: TEXTILE CARE

This is the knowledge needed to properly care for garments to make them last.

1. SORTING

Before washing, laundry *must* be sorted to prevent disaster.

- **By Color:**
 - **Whites:** (White T-shirts, bedsheets)
 - **Lights:** (Pastel colors, light grey)
 - **Darks:** (Black, navy, dark red, brown, purple)
 - *Why?* To prevent **color bleeding** (dyes from dark clothes staining light clothes).
- **By Fabric Type:**
 - **Normals:** (Cotton, Polyester, Denim)
 - **Delicates:** (Silk, Lace, delicate synthetics)
 - *Why?* Delicates need a gentle wash; normals can take a stronger one.
- **By Soil Level:** (e.g., muddy P.E. clothes vs. a lightly worn shirt).

2. WASHING

- **Water Temperature:**
 - **Hot (60°C+):** Best for whites, towels, bedsheets. It **sanitizes** and removes heavy dirt.
 - **Warm (30-40°C):** Best for colored clothes. Cleans well without causing fading or shrinking.
 - **Cold (20°C):** Best for darks (prevents fading) and delicates.
- **Detergents:**
 - *Soaps:* Made from natural fats/oils.
 - *Synthetic Detergents (e.g., Omo, Ariel):* Man-made. More effective in "hard" water.

3. BLEACHING

- **Purpose:** To whiten, brighten, and sanitize.
- **Chlorine Bleach (e.g., JIK):**
 - **Use:** For **WHITES ONLY**.

- **Warning:** It will *destroy* (dissolve) **Wool** and **Silk** and will remove the color from colored fabrics.
- **Oxygen Bleach (e.g., "Color-Safe" Bleach):**
 - **Use:** Gentler, safe for *all* fabrics and colors.

4. DRYING

- **Machine (Tumble) Drying:** Fast, but the heat can cause shrinking or damage delicate fabrics.
- **Line Drying (Sun):** Natural, free, and the sun has a bleaching/sanitizing effect. Best for whites. Can fade dark colors over time.
- **Flat Drying:** Used for wool sweaters, which must be laid flat to keep their shape.

5. PRESSING (IRONING)

- The iron's temperature *must* be set for the fibre type.
- **High Heat:** Cotton, Linen
- **Medium Heat:** Wool, Polyester
- **Low Heat:** Silk, Nylon, Acrylic (these will *melt* on high heat).

6. INTERNATIONAL CARE LABELS

These are picture-symbols used worldwide to explain *how* to care for a garment.

- **Wash Tub:** Represents washing (a number inside is the max °C; a hand means "hand-wash").
- **Triangle:** Represents bleaching (a plain triangle = bleach allowed; a crossed-out triangle = do not bleach).
- **Square:** Represents drying (a circle in a square = tumble dry; a line = line dry).
- **Iron:** Represents pressing (dots indicate temperature: 1 dot = Low, 2 = Medium, 3 = High).
- **Circle:** Represents **Dry Cleaning** (for professionals only).

PART 2: TEXTILE FINISHES

These are industrial treatments applied *after* weaving to improve the fabric.

- **A. AESTHETIC FINISHES (Changing the Look/Feel)**
 - **BLEACHING:** An industrial finish to make fabrics pure white before dyeing.
 - **DYEING:** The process of adding **solid color** to a fabric.
 - *Yarn-Dyeing:* The *yarn* is dyed *before* weaving (e.g., *Aso-Oke*, Gingham).
 - *Piece-Dyeing:* The whole *fabric* (piece) is dyed after weaving (most common).
 - **PRINTING:** The process of applying a **pattern** to the *surface* of a fabric.
 - *Roller Printing:* How *Ankara* is made. Fast, mass production.
 - *Screen Printing:* How T-shirt graphics are made.
 - *Resist Dyeing* (e.g., *Adire*): A traditional method where parts of the fabric are "resisted" (with wax or tie) from the dye.
- **B. FUNCTIONAL FINISHES (Changing the Performance)**
 - **MERCERIZATION:** A chemical process for **cotton**. It makes the fibre swell, becoming **stronger, more absorbent**, and much more **lustrous (shinier)**.
 - **SANFORIZING (PRE-SHRUNK):** A mechanical process that pre-shrinks the fabric, so it will not shrink when the customer washes it.
 - **FLAME-RETARDANT:** A chemical finish that makes fabric difficult to ignite. Often required by law for children's sleepwear and furniture.
 - **WATER-REPELLENT:** A finish that makes fabric resist water (e.g., for raincoats).

EVALUATION

1. List the three main ways laundry should be *sorted* before washing.
2. What is the key difference between Chlorine Bleach and Oxygen Bleach?

3. Draw and label the 5 basic international care symbols (Washing, Bleaching, Drying, Ironing, Dry Cleaning).
4. What is the difference between "Dyeing" and "Printing"?
5. What is "Mercerization," and what three benefits does it give to cotton?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Find a white cotton fabric (e.g., an old T-shirt or handkerchief). With supervision, dye one half of it using a traditional method (e.g., tying it with rubber bands and dipping in *Adire* dye or even strong tea/coffee) to create a "tie-dye" pattern. Write a paragraph on the process.
2. **Practical:** Look at the iron in your home. Identify the temperature settings for different fabrics (e.g., Cotton, Wool, Polyester).
3. Write a 200-word report on the "dos and don'ts" of washing a dark, new T-shirt for the *first* time. (Hint: color bleeding).
4. Define: Sanforizing, Color Bleeding, Detergent, Resist Dyeing, Filament.
5. Why is it dangerous to iron Nylon or Polyester on the "Cotton" setting?

WEEK 11-13: REVISION & EXAMS

REVISION OF ALL FIRST TERM TOPICS

This period is for a comprehensive review of all concepts covered this term, in preparation for the final examination.

- **WEEK 1: FOUNDATIONS**

- **Fashion:** The *style/trend*.
- **Garment Making:** The *craft/skill*.
- **Importance:** Protection, Modesty, ID, Self-Expression (Individual); Job Creation, GDP, Cultural ID (Economic).
- **Careers:** Design, Production (Tailor, Pattern Maker), Media (Stylist), Business (Buyer).

- **WEEK 2: HISTORY**

- **Evolution:** From animal skins (Protection) → Roman Toga (Status) → Industrial Revolution (Mass Production) → 20th Century (Youth-driven).
- **Nigeria: Yoruba** (*Aso-Oke, Agbada, Gele*), **Igbo** (*Isiagu, Akwaete, Coral Beads*), **Hausa-Fulani** (*Babban Riga, Embroidery, Hijab*).

- **WEEK 3: TOOLS I**

- **Cutting:** Shears (fabric), Pinking Shears (fraying), Seam Ripper (mistakes).
- **Measuring:** Tape Measure (body), Tailor's Square/French Curve (patterns), Seam Gauge (hems).
- **Pressing:** Iron, Ironing Board, **Tailor's Ham** (curves), **Press Cloth** (protection).

- **WEEK 4: TOOLS II (SEWING MACHINE)**

- **Parts:** Spool Pin, Tension Regulator, Take-up Lever, Needle, Presser Foot, Feed Dog, Bobbin, Hand Wheel, Foot Pedal.
- **Stitch:** Creates a **Lockstitch**.
- **Maintenance:** Cleaning (lint), Oiling, Changing Needles.

- **WEEK 6: WORKSHOP SAFETY**

- **Rules:** No running, clean workspace, pass shears handle-first, don't sew over pins, rest iron on its heel.
- **First Aid:** Cuts (wash, antiseptic, plaster), Burns (cool running water 10+ mins).
- **Electrical:** Dry hands, unplug by the plug.
- **WEEK 8: FIBRES I (TYPES)**
 - **Natural (Plant/Cellulosic):** Cotton (absorbent, wrinkles), Linen (strong, cool).
 - **Natural (Animal/Protein):** Wool (warm, shrinks), Silk (lustrous, strong).
 - **Synthetic (Petrochemical):** Polyester (wrinkle-resistant, non-absorbent), Nylon (strong, elastic).
 - **Regenerated:** Rayon (drapes, weak when wet).
- **WEEK 9: FABRICS II (SELECTION)**
 - **Factors:** End Use, Aesthetics (Drape/Lustre), Comfort (Absorbency), Durability, Care, Cost.
 - **Examples:** Uniform (Poly-Cotton), Agbada (Brocade), Sportswear (Polyester/Spandex), Baby (Cotton).
- **WEEK 10: TEXTILE CARE & FINISHES**
 - **Care:** Sorting (color, type), Washing (temp), Bleaching (Chlorine vs. Oxygen), Care Labels.
 - **Finishes:** Dyeing (solid color) vs. Printing (pattern), Mercerization (stronger/shinier cotton), Sanforizing (pre-shrinks).

FINAL EXAMINATION

The final examination will test all aspects of this term's work, including definitions, comparisons, identification of tools and fabrics, and scenario-based questions (e.g., "What fabric would you choose for...").

Here are comprehensive, detailed, and expansive lesson notes for the SS1 Second Term Fashion Design & Garment Making scheme of work.

SS 1 FASHION DESIGN AND GARMENT MAKING LESSON NOTES

SECOND TERM

WEEK 1: BASIC SEWING STITCHES I

TOPIC: TEMPORARY STITCHES (TACKING, BASTING)



INTRODUCTION

Welcome to the second term. In the first term, we learned about the tools of our craft. This term, we learn to *use* them. The most fundamental skill in all garment making is the **stitch**. A stitch is

a single loop of thread or yarn that is passed through fabric, either by hand or by machine, to join layers of fabric together or to create a design.

Stitches are divided into two main categories: **Temporary** and **Permanent**.

MEANING AND PURPOSE OF TEMPORARY STITCHES

Temporary stitches (also known as **tacking** or **basting**) are large, loose stitches that are *not* intended to be a final part of the garment. They are a "holding" tool, just like pins, but are stronger and more stable.

Their key purposes are:

1. **To Hold Seams:** To securely hold two or more layers of fabric together in preparation for permanent machine sewing.
2. **To Check Fit:** They allow a garment to be "fitted" on a person. If adjustments are needed (e.g., make it tighter), the temporary stitches can be easily removed without damaging the fabric.
3. **To Guide:** They act as a guideline for complex seams, zippers, or topstitching.
4. **To Transfer Markings:** Used to transfer pattern markings (like darts) from the paper pattern to the fabric.

Characteristics of Temporary Stitches:

- They are sewn with a **single thread** (no knot at the end) for easy removal.
- They are large and spaced far apart.
- They are typically sewn in a **contrasting thread color** (e.g., white thread on black fabric) so they are easy to see and remove later.

TYPES OF TEMPORARY STITCHES

1. *EVEN TACKING (BASTING)*

- **Description:** This is the most common temporary stitch. It consists of stitches of *uniform length* on both sides of the fabric. The stitch length and the space between stitches are the same.

- **How to Sew:**

- a. Thread a needle with a single, long thread in a contrasting color. Do *not* make a knot.
 - b. Make a small backstitch to secure the first stitch (or just hold the tail).
 - c. Weave the needle in and out of the fabric, making stitches that are about **1cm (1/4 inch)** long, with **1cm** spaces in between.
 - d. Finish with a small backstitch to secure the end.
- **Use:** Used on most seams, especially curved areas (like armholes or necklines) that require close control.

2. UNEVEN TACKING (BASTING)

- **Description:** A faster version of tacking where the *top* stitch is long and the *space* (or bottom stitch) is short.
- **How to Sew:**
 - a. Make a long stitch on top (about **1.5cm - 2cm**).
 - b. Make a very small "holding" stitch underneath (about **0.5cm**).
 - c. Repeat, creating a long-short-long-short pattern.
- **Use:** Good for long, straight seams (like the side seam of a skirt or trousers) where the fabric is stable and doesn't need as much control.

3. DIAGONAL TACKING

- **Description:** A stitch where the thread runs *diagonally* across the fabric. On the top, you see parallel diagonal lines. On the bottom, you see small, parallel horizontal or vertical stitches.
- **How to Sew:**
 - a. Hold the needle parallel to the fabric edge.
 - b. Pick up a small stitch (vertical).
 - c. Move the needle diagonally (e.g., 2cm) to the side and up.
 - d. Pick up another small stitch (vertical).
 - e. This creates a "staircase" or "chevron" pattern.

- **Use:** Used to hold large, flat areas of fabric together. It is essential for **tailoring**, such as holding the *interfacing* (the stiffening fabric) to the inside of a jacket lapel or collar.

4. TAILOR'S TACKS

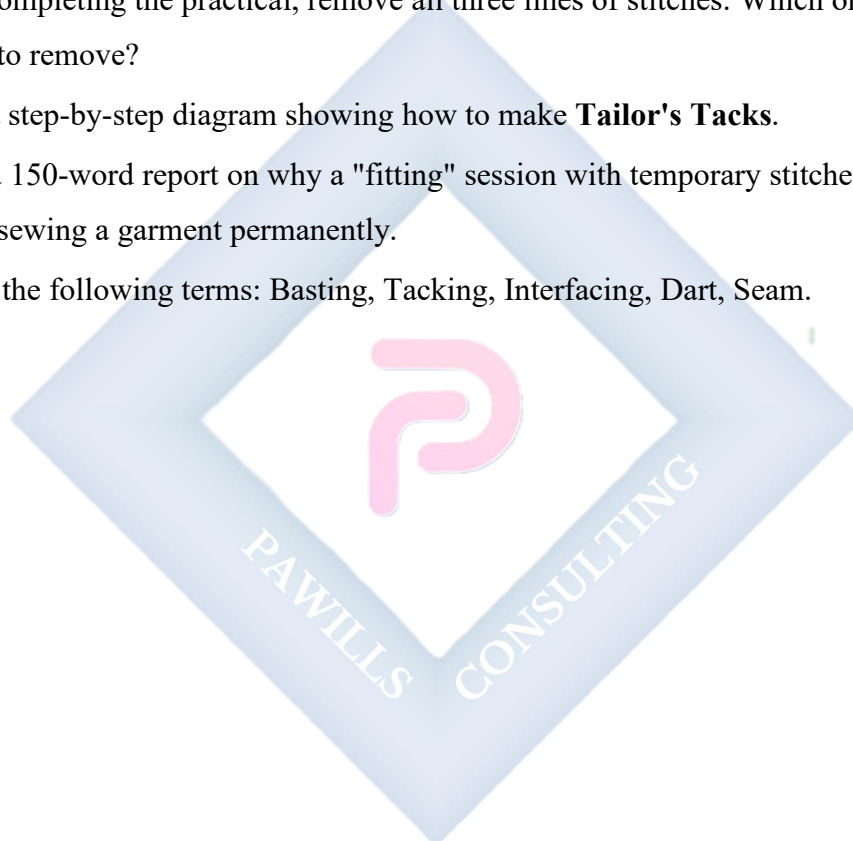
- **Description:** This is the *most important* temporary stitch for **transferring pattern markings**. It is not a "line" of stitching; it is a series of "tufts" of thread.
- **Purpose:** To transfer markings from a paper pattern (like the point of a dart, or a pocket placement) onto *both* layers of fabric at the same time, with perfect accuracy.
- **How to Sew:**
 - a. Use a **double thread** (not single) in a contrasting color. Do not make a knot.
 - b. With the paper pattern still on the fabric, take a small stitch (e.g., 1cm) *through* the pattern and *through both* layers of fabric.
 - c. Pull the thread, but leave a "tail" (e.g., 3cm long).
 - d. Take a second stitch *in the same hole*, but this time, leave a **large loop** (e.g., 3cm high).
 - e. Cut the thread, leaving another long tail. You now have a stitch with two tails and one loop.
 - f. Carefully remove the paper pattern.
 - g. Gently pull the two layers of fabric apart, which pulls the loops flat.
 - h. **Snip the threads** that are *between* the two fabric layers.
- **Result:** You are left with two "tufts" of thread on the *top* layer and two "tufts" on the *bottom* layer, perfectly marking the same spot.

EVALUATION

1. What are the four main purposes of temporary stitches?
2. Why is a temporary stitch sewn in a contrasting thread color?
3. What is the main difference in *appearance* and *use* between even tacking and uneven tacking?
4. What is the *unique* function of Tailor's Tacks?
5. What is diagonal tacking primarily used for in tailoring?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Get a 30cm x 30cm piece of scrap fabric (e.g., old bedsheet), a needle, and thread of a contrasting color.
 - Fold the fabric in half.
 - Sew a 15cm line of **Even Tacking**.
 - Sew a 15cm line of **Uneven Tacking**.
 - Sew a 15cm line of **Diagonal Tacking**.
2. After completing the practical, remove all three lines of stitches. Which one was the *fastest* to remove?
3. Draw a step-by-step diagram showing how to make **Tailor's Tacks**.
4. Write a 150-word report on why a "fitting" session with temporary stitches is essential before sewing a garment permanently.
5. Define the following terms: Basting, Tacking, Interfacing, Dart, Seam.



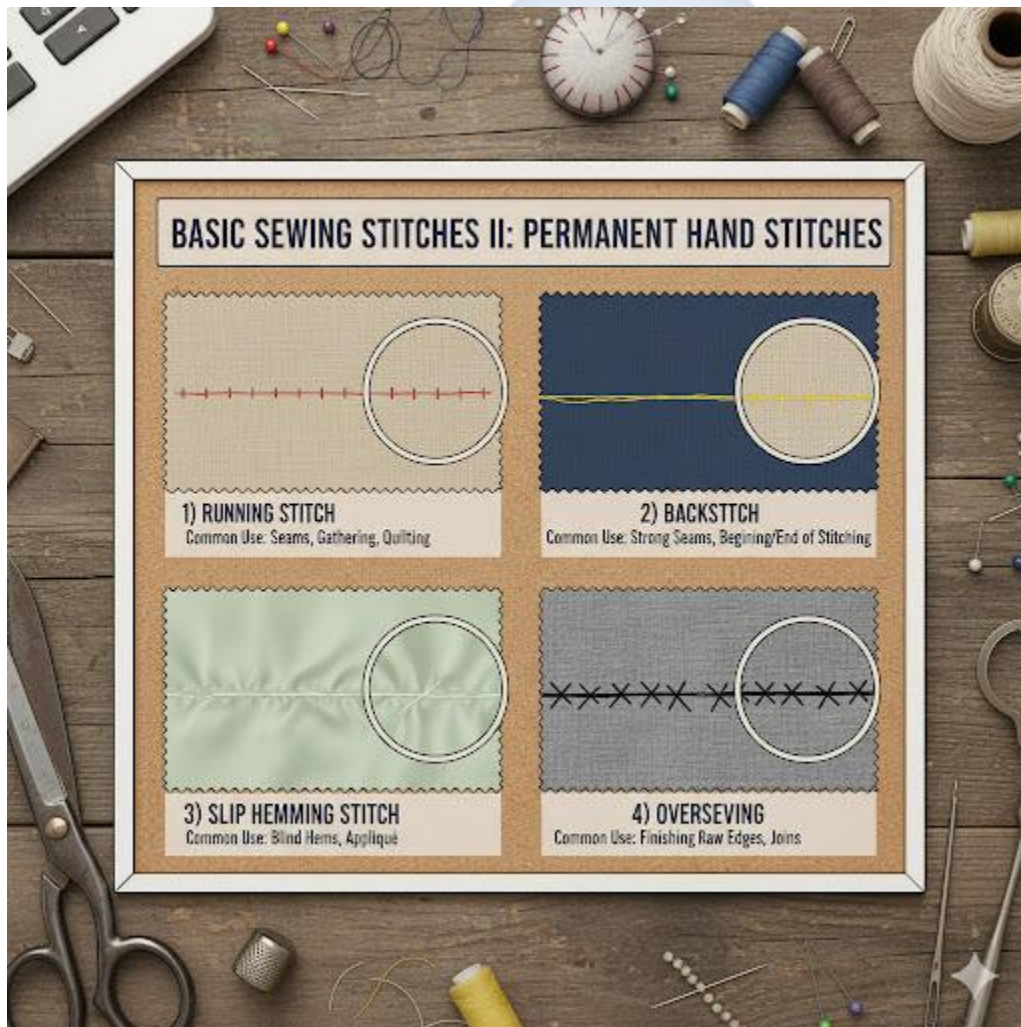
WEEK 2: BASIC SEWING STITCHES II

TOPIC: PERMANENT STITCHES (HAND)

INTRODUCTION

While temporary stitches are designed to be removed, **permanent stitches** are designed to be strong, durable, and last for the entire life of the garment. They are sewn with a **matching thread color** and are made small and tight.

Even with a sewing machine, every garment maker *must* master permanent hand stitches for finishing, mending, and attaching details like buttons and hooks.



TYPES OF PERMANENT HAND STITCHES

1. RUNNING STITCH

- **Description:** This is the simplest and most basic permanent stitch. It is an "in-and-out" stitch of small, even lengths.
- **How to Sew:**
 - a. Use a single thread (for light fabrics) or double thread (for strength) and make a secure knot at the end.
 - b. From the wrong side, push the needle up at the starting point.
 - c. Weave the needle in and out of the fabric 2 or 3 times before pulling the thread through.
 - d. The stitches and spaces should be very small (approx. 2-3mm).
- **Use:**
 - Mending simple seams.
 - **Gathering** (when the stitches are sewn long and then pulled - see Week 6).
 - Quilting and embroidery.

2. BACKSTITCH

- **Description:** This is the **strongest hand stitch**. It is designed to look like a machine stitch from the top. It creates a solid, unbroken line of thread.
- **How to Sew:**
 - a. Make a knot and pull the needle up at the start point (let's call it Point A).
 - b. Take one stitch *forward* (e.g., 3mm) and go down (Point B).
 - c. Bring the needle *back up* one stitch length *ahead* (Point C).
 - d. Now, stitch *backwards*, putting the needle *into the same hole* as the end of the first stitch (Point B).
 - e. Bring the needle up one stitch length ahead (Point D).
 - f. Stitch *backwards* into (Point C).
- **Visual:**
 - Top (Right Side): C B A (Looks solid: ----)
 - Bottom (Wrong Side): (Looks lapped: // /)

- **Use:**
 - **Essential** for securing seams where there is high stress (e.g., a crotch seam, attaching a zipper by hand).
 - Repairing broken machine seams.
 - Securing the beginning and end of other stitches (as a knot).

3. HEMMING STITCHES

- **Purpose:** The "hem" is the finished bottom edge of a garment (e.g., the bottom of a skirt, trousers, or sleeve). Hemming stitches are used to secure this folded edge. The goal is to be as **invisible** as possible from the *right side* of the garment.
- **Types of Hemming Stitches:**
 - **A. SLANT HEMMING (SLIP STITCH):**
 - **Description:** The most common and versatile hemming stitch. It creates small, diagonal (slanted) stitches on the *inside* of the hem.
 - **How to Sew:**
 1. Prepare the hem (fold and press).
 2. Work from right to left (if right-handed).
 3. Hide the knot *inside* the hem fold.
 4. Pick up *only one or two threads* from the main garment fabric (this is the key to invisibility).
 5. Move the needle diagonally up and slide it *through* the folded edge of the hem (about 1cm).
 6. Repeat. (Tiny stitch in the garment, short stitch in the hem).
 - **B. BLIND HEMMING STITCH:**
 - **Description:** A variation that is almost 100% invisible. The stitches are taken *inside* the hem fold.
 - **How to Sew:**
 1. Fold the hem edge back on itself.
 2. Take a tiny stitch (1 thread) from the garment.
 3. Take a tiny stitch from the *folded edge* of the hem.

4. Repeat, alternating. The main thread is hidden *between* the layers.

○ **C. MACHINE HEM (TOPSTITCHING):**

- **Description:** The fastest, strongest, but *most visible* hem.
- **How to Sew:** Simply fold and press the hem, then use a straight machine stitch to sew it down.
- **Use:** For casual garments like jeans, T-shirts, and uniforms.

4. *OVERSEWING (WHIPSTITCH)*

- **Description:** A strong, close stitch used to join two *finished edges* of fabric.
- **How to Sew:**
 - a. Hold the two finished edges (selvedges or folded edges) together.
 - b. Work from right to left.
 - c. Insert the needle from back to front, passing *over* the top edge of the fabric.
 - d. The stitches are small and diagonal, wrapping around the edge.
- **Use:** Closing the opening of a pillow, applying lace, mending a split seam.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference in *purpose* between a temporary stitch and a permanent stitch?
2. What is the **strongest** permanent hand stitch, and why?
3. Describe the step-by-step process of sewing a **Backstitch**.
4. What is the primary goal of a hemming stitch?
5. What is the difference between a **Running Stitch** and an **Oversewing Stitch**?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Get a 30cm x 30cm piece of scrap fabric, folded in half (RST).
 - Sew a 10cm seam using a **Running Stitch**.
 - Sew a 10cm seam using a **Backstitch**.
 - Pull on both seams. Write a paragraph describing the difference in strength you observed.
2. **Practical:** Take another piece of scrap fabric.

- Fold and press a 2cm hem.
 - Sew the hem using the **Slant Hemming (Slip Stitch)** method. .
3. Draw a clear, labeled diagram showing what a **Backstitch** looks like on the *top* of the fabric versus the *bottom*.
 4. Research the "Blind Hem Stitch." Draw a diagram showing how it is sewn.
 5. Define the following terms: Selvedge, Hem, Hem Allowance, Gathering, Right Side (of fabric).

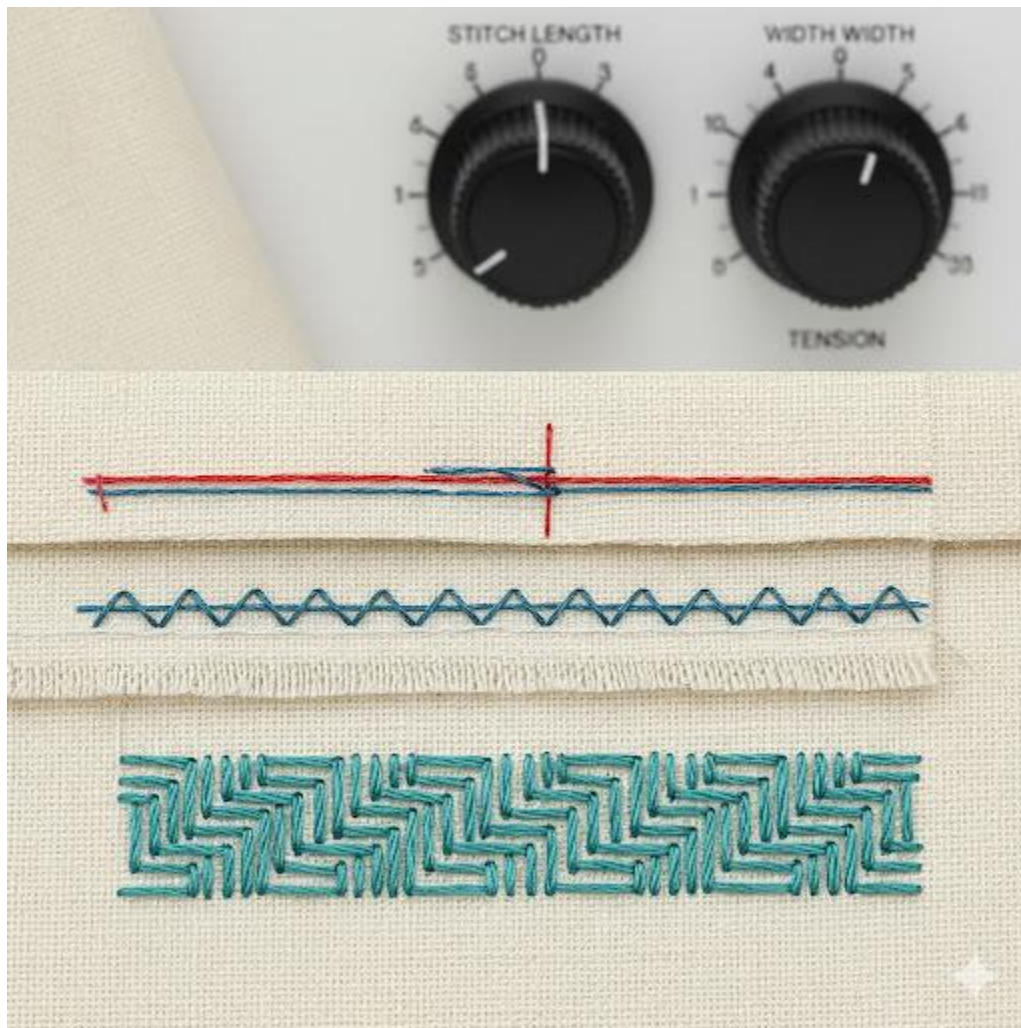


WEEK 3: MACHINE STITCHES

INTRODUCTION

In the first term (Week 4), we learned the *parts* of the sewing machine. Now, we learn to *use* it. The sewing machine creates stitches by interlocking a **top thread** (from the needle) with a **bottom thread** (from the **bobbin**). This is called a **Lockstitch**.

Mastering the machine means mastering its settings: Stitch Length, Stitch Width, and Tension.



KEY MACHINE SETTINGS

1. STITCH LENGTH DIAL:

- **Function:** Controls the *length* of each individual stitch (how far the **feed dog** moves the fabric).
- **Settings (Typical):**
 - **0:** Needle sews in one spot (used for darning or free-motion).
 - **1-2:** Very short, tight stitches (used for buttonholes or reinforcing).
 - **2.5-3:** The **standard length** for all construction seams.
 - **4-5:** Longest stitch (used for **gathering** and **tacking/basting**).

2. STITCH WIDTH DIAL:

- **Function:** Controls the *width* (side-to-side motion) of the stitch.
- **Settings (Typical):**
 - **0:** The needle does *not* move side-to-side. This is the setting for a **Straight Stitch**.
 - **1-5:** The needle swings from side to side. This creates a **Zigzag Stitch**. "5" is the widest zigzag.

3. TENSION DIAL:

- **Function:** This is the most important adjustment. It controls the **tightness** of the *upper (needle) thread*.
- **Perfect Tension:** The top and bottom threads "lock" *in the middle* of the fabric. The stitch looks identical on both sides.
- **Bad Tension (Too Tight):** The top thread is too tight. It *pulls the bobbin thread up* to the top surface. The fabric may pucker. (To fix: *lower* the tension number).
- **Bad Tension (Too Loose):** The top thread is too loose. The *top thread is pulled down* to the bottom surface, creating loops. (To fix: *raise* the tension number).

TYPES OF MACHINE STITCHES

1. STRAIGHT STITCH (LOCKSTITCH)

- **Description:** The most important and common stitch. It is a single, straight line of locked stitches.
- **Settings:**

- Stitch Selector: **Straight Stitch**
- Stitch Width: **0** (This is essential)
- Stitch Length: **2.5 - 3** (for seams) or **4-5** (for gathering)
- **Use:** Used for over 90% of all sewing, including all **seam construction**, **topstitching**, and **hemming**.
- **Backstitching (Locking):** You *must* lock the stitch at the beginning and end of every seam. To do this, you sew forward 2-3 stitches, then press and hold the **Reverse Lever**, sew backward 2-3 stitches, release, and then sew forward normally.

2. ZIGZAG STITCH

- **Description:** A continuous, side-to-side "Z" shaped stitch.
- **Settings:**
 - Stitch Selector: **Zigzag**
 - Stitch Width: **1 - 5** (as desired)
 - Stitch Length: **1 - 3** (a shorter length creates a *denser* stitch, called a "satin stitch")
- **Uses:**
 - a. **Seam Finish (Primary Use):** Sewn on the *raw edge* of a seam allowance to **prevent fraying**. It is the most common alternative to an Overlocker.
 - b. **Sewing Stretch Fabrics:** A narrow zigzag (e.g., Width 1, Length 2) will *stretch* with the fabric, whereas a straight stitch will snap.
 - c. **Applying Elastic:** Used to sew elastic bands onto waistbands.
 - d. **Buttonholes:** A buttonhole is made of two very dense zigzag stitches (satin stitches) close together.

3. DECORATIVE STITCHES

- **Description:** Any stitch that is purely for *ornamentation* (decoration). Modern machines have many built-in options.
- **Settings:**
 - Stitch Selector: **(Icon)** e.g., Scallop, Honeycomb, Feather Stitch.
 - The machine will often recommend the correct length and width.
- **Uses:**

- Adding a decorative border to a hem (e.g., on a pillowcase).
- "Topstitching" on a garment (e.g., a child's dress).
- Quilting.

EVALUATION

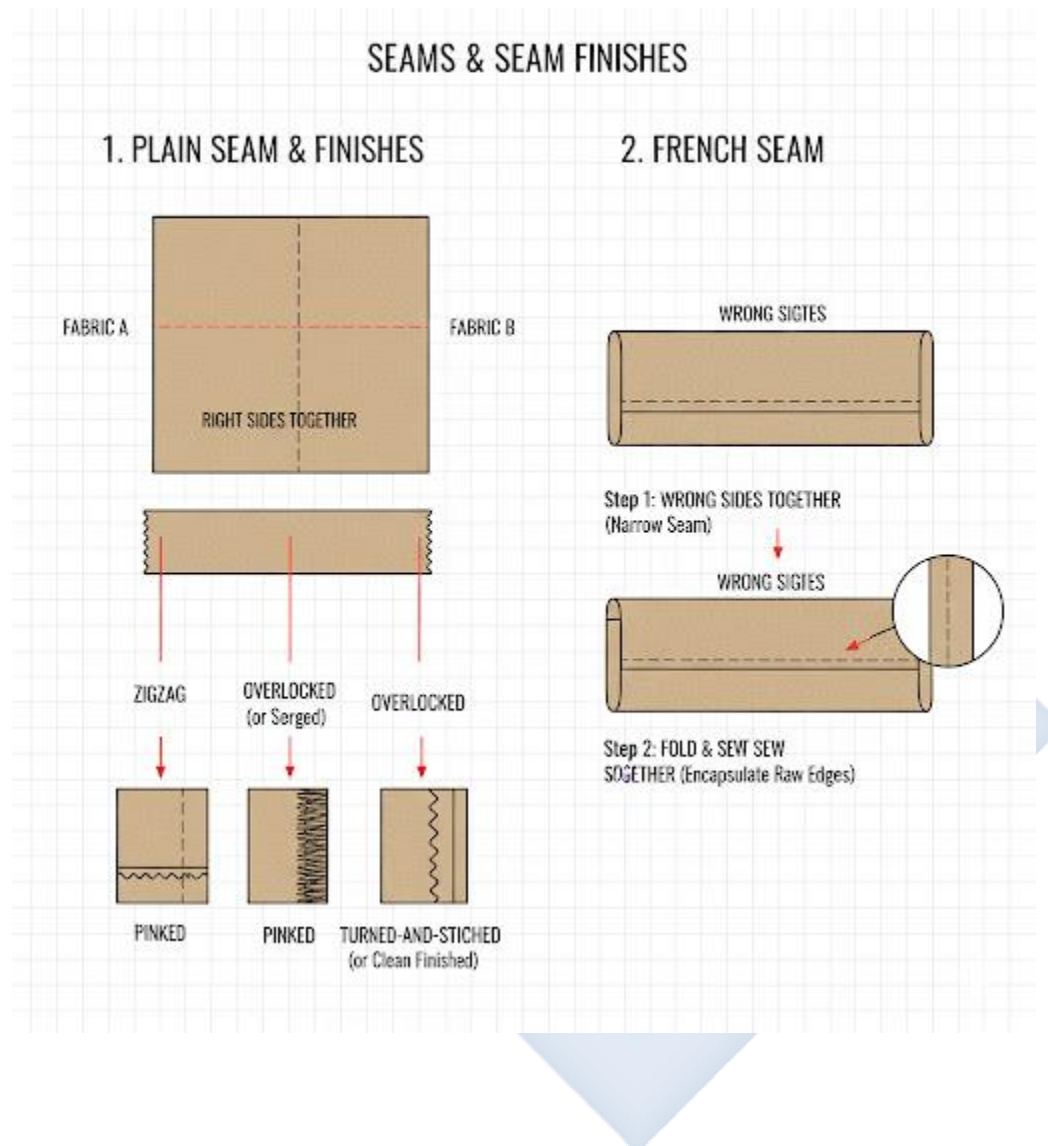
1. What is a "Lockstitch"?
2. What are the two *main uses* of a Zigzag Stitch?
3. What does the "Stitch Length" dial control? What is the correct setting for a standard seam?
4. A student's machine is making loops on the *bottom* of the fabric. Is their *top* tension too tight or too loose? How should they fix it?
5. How do you "lock" a seam at the beginning and end of sewing on a machine?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Using a sewing machine and scrap fabric:
 - (a) Sew a 15cm straight line, making sure to **backstitch** at the beginning and end.
 - (b) Sew a 15cm **zigzag stitch** with a medium width (e.g., 3).
 - (c) Sew a 15cm "satin stitch" (zigzag with width 3, length 0.5).
 - (d) Sew one of the machine's **decorative stitches**.
2. **Practical:** Draw a 15cm line on fabric. Practice sewing *perfectly* on the line. Then, practice sewing *1cm away* from the edge, using the seam guides on the throat plate.
3. Draw a clear diagram showing (a) Perfect Tension, (b) Top Tension Too Tight, and (c) Top Tension Too Loose.
4. Write a 150-word report on why a straight stitch is *not* suitable for sewing stretch fabrics (like P.E. shorts or "leggings").
5. Define: Lockstitch, Bobbin, Tension, Feed Dog, Seam Guides, Backstitching.

WEEK 4: SEAMS & SEAM FINISHES

INTRODUCTION



This week, we combine our knowledge of stitches (hand and machine) to create **seams**.

- **SEAM:** A **seam** is the line where two or more layers of fabric are joined together by stitching. It is the basic "joint" in all garment construction.
- **SEAM ALLOWANCE:** The area of fabric *between* the sewing line (the seam) and the raw edge of the fabric. (Standard seam allowance is 1.5cm or 5/8 inch).
- **SEAM FINISH:** A **seam finish** is any technique used to treat the *raw edge* of the seam allowance to make it neat and, most importantly, to **prevent it from fraying** (unraveling).

1. TYPES OF SEAMS

A. PLAIN SEAM

- **Description:** This is the most fundamental and widely used seam in all sewing.
- **How to Sew:**
 - a. Place the two pieces of fabric **Right Sides Together (RST)**. (This means the "good" sides of the fabric are facing each other).
 - b. Pin the fabric together.
 - c. Using a **straight machine stitch** (length 2.5-3), sew a straight line at the designated seam allowance (e.g., 1.5cm).
 - d. Backstitch at the beginning and end.
- **Use:** For 90% of all seams (side seams, shoulder seams, etc.)
- **Crucial Note:** A plain seam is *not* finished. The raw edges on the inside must now be treated with a **seam finish**.

B. FRENCH SEAM

- **Description:** This is a beautiful, high-quality "seam within a seam." It is an **enclosed seam**, meaning the raw edges are completely hidden *inside* the seam.
- **How to Sew (Two-Step Process):**
 - a. **STEP 1:** Place the fabric **WRONG SIDES TOGETHER (WST)**. (This is the *opposite* of a plain seam).
 - b. Sew a very small seam (e.g., 0.5cm) with a straight stitch.
 - c. Trim this seam allowance down very neatly and closely (e.g., to 0.3cm).
 - d. Press the seam flat.
 - e. **STEP 2:** Fold the fabric along the new seam, so the fabric is now **RIGHT SIDES TOGETHER (RST)**. The first seam is now "trapped" inside.
 - f. Press again.
 - g. Sew a *second* seam (e.g., 1cm), making sure you are completely *enclosing* the first seam.

- h. Press the final seam to one side.
- **Use:** For **delicate, lightweight, or transparent fabrics** like chiffon, organza, and silk. It is a neat, strong, and professional finish that looks beautiful from the inside.
- **Do Not Use:** On thick or heavy fabrics (like denim or brocade), as it will be too bulky.

2. SEAM FINISHES (FOR A PLAIN SEAM)

After you sew a plain seam, you are left with two raw edges on the inside. You must finish them.

A. PRESSING (THE FIRST STEP)

- **OPEN SEAM:** The seam allowances are "pressed open" (one to the left, one to the right) with an iron. This is the flattest possible finish, used in high-quality tailoring.
- **CLOSED SEAM:** The seam allowances are pressed *together* to one side.

B. FINISHING THE RAW EDGE

1. OVERLOCKED (SERGED):

- **How:** Using a special machine called an **Overlocker** (or **Serger**).
- **Function:** This machine *trims* the raw edge and *wraps* it in 3 or 4 threads, all in one pass.
- **Use:** This is the standard, fast, and professional finish for all **commercially made** (ready-to-wear) garments.

2. ZIGZAG FINISH:

- **How:** (As learned in Week 3). Set the machine to a zigzag stitch (e.g., Width 3, Length 2).
- **Function:** Sew the zigzag stitch along the *very edge* of the seam allowance.
- **Use:** This is the most common and effective finish for anyone using a standard domestic sewing machine.

3. PINKING:

- **How:** Using **Pinking Shears** (from 1st Term, Wk 3) to cut along the raw edge.
- **Function:** The "sawtooth" pattern prevents fraying.

- **Use:** A very *fast* but *weak* finish. Only suitable for stable, non-fraying fabrics (like polyester) or for garments that will not be washed often.

4. **TURNED-AND-STITCHED (OR CLEAN FINISH):**

- **How:** (1) Press the seam open. (2) Fold the *very edge* (0.5cm) of *each* seam allowance under itself. (3) Press. (4) Sew a straight stitch along that tiny fold.
- **Use:** A beautiful, high-quality, but time-consuming finish. Used for unlined jackets and skirts.

EVALUATION

1. What is a "seam"?
2. What is a "seam finish," and what is its primary purpose?
3. What does "RST" mean, and for which seam is it used?
4. Describe the *first step* of sewing a French Seam. Why is it different from a plain seam?
5. What is an "Overlocker" (Serge), and what is its main advantage?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Take two 20cm x 20cm squares of fabric.
 - (a) Sew a 15cm **Plain Seam** (RST).
 - (b) Press the seam allowance **open**.
 - (c) Finish *both* raw edges using a **Zigzag Stitch**.
2. **Practical:** Take two 20cm x 20cm squares of a *lightweight* fabric (if possible).
 - (a) Sew a 15cm **French Seam**.
 - (b) Press and examine your seam. Is the raw edge completely hidden?
3. Draw a clear, step-by-step diagram illustrating how to sew a **French Seam**.
4. Write a 150-word report comparing the **Zigzag Finish** to the **Pinking Finish**. Which one is stronger, and why?
5. Define: Seam Allowance, Fraying, RST (Right Sides Together), WST (Wrong Sides Together), Bulky.

WEEK 6: FULLNESS TECHNIQUES I

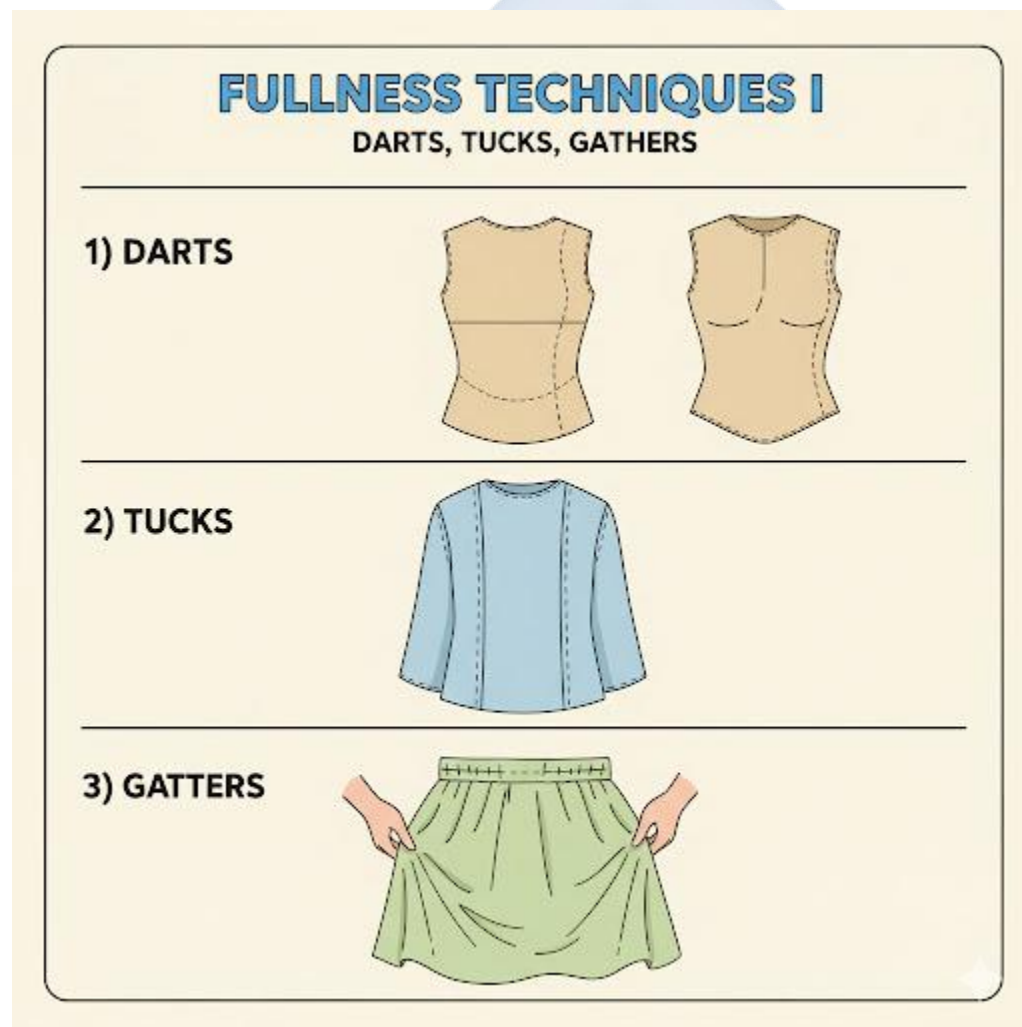
TOPIC: DARTS, TUCKS, GATHERS

INTRODUCTION

The human body is not flat. It is a 3-dimensional (3D) form, full of curves (like the bust, hips, and waist). Fabric, on the other hand, is 2-dimensional (2D) and flat.

"Fullness Techniques" (or "Controlling Fullness") are the essential methods used by designers and tailors to turn that flat 2D fabric into a 3D garment that fits the body's curves.

This week, we study the three most common methods.



1. DARTS

- **DEFINITION:** A **dart** is a V-shaped, folded-and-sewn wedge of fabric. It is the most basic and important structural element for shaping a garment.
- **FUNCTION:** To *remove* excess fabric in one area to allow it to *fit* over a curve in another. It "builds" a 3D cone shape out of the flat fabric.
- **PARTS OF A DART:**
 - **Dart Legs:** The two "sides" of the V.
 - **Apex:** The "point" of the V, which must point directly to the *fullest part* of the body's curve (e.g., the bust point or the hip point).
 - **Dart Intake:** The amount of fabric *between* the dart legs at the wide end.
- **HOW TO SEW:**
 - a. Transfer the dart markings (the V) from the pattern to the *wrong side* of the fabric (Tailor's Tacks are perfect for this).
 - b. Fold the fabric **Right Sides Together**, matching the two dart legs perfectly. Pin.
 - c. Sew from the *wide end* (the dart intake) to the *apex* (the point).
 - d. **Crucial:** Do *not* backstitch at the apex. Instead, sew *off* the fabric and leave long thread tails. Tie these tails in a secure hand-knot. (Backstitching at the point will create a "pucker").
- **USE:**
 - **Bust Darts:** To shape the fabric around the bust.
 - **Waist Darts:** To pull the fabric in at the waist (on blouses, skirts, and trousers).
 - **Shoulder Darts / Elbow Darts:** For a closer fit on jackets.
- **PRESSING:** Darts are *always* pressed to one side. Vertical darts (waist) are pressed towards the **center** (Center Front/Center Back). Horizontal darts (bust) are pressed **downwards**.

2. TUCKS

- **DEFINITION:** A **tuck** is a *stitched fold* of fabric. Unlike a dart, it does *not* taper to a point. It is a straight, parallel fold.
- **FUNCTION:** Tucks can be used to control fullness (like a dart), but they are most often **decorative**.
- **TYPES:**
 - **PIN TUCKS:** Very narrow, delicate stitched folds (1-2mm wide). Often used in groups on blouses, children's wear, or pillowcases.
 - **SPACED TUCKS:** Wider tucks (e.g., 1 cm) with a gap between each one.
 - **BLIND TUCKS:** Tucks that are folded to overlap each other, so you cannot see the stitching.
- **HOW TO SEW (PIN TUCK):**
 - a. Fold the fabric (wrong sides together).
 - b. Press the fold.
 - c. Sew a straight stitch very close to the folded edge (e.g., 2mm away).
 - d. Press the tuck flat to one side.
 - e. Repeat for the next tuck.

3. GATHERS

- **DEFINITION:** **Gathers** are a technique for drawing a *long* piece of fabric onto a *short* piece of fabric, creating soft, feminine folds.
- **FUNCTION:** To add fullness in a non-structured, decorative way.
- **HOW TO SEW:**
 - a. Set the sewing machine to its **longest stitch length** (e.g., 4 or 5). **Do not backstitch.**
 - b. Sew **two parallel lines** of stitches, about 0.5cm apart, within the seam allowance of the fabric to be gathered.
 - c. Leave long thread tails at both ends.
 - d. Separate the threads. Take *only the two bobbin (bottom) threads*.

- e. Gently **pull** these two bobbin threads. The fabric will "gather up" along the threads.
 - f. Distribute the gathers evenly until the long piece of fabric fits the short piece (e.g., a skirt waistband).
 - g. Secure the threads by wrapping them in a "figure 8" around a pin.
 - h. Pin the gathered piece to the flat piece (RST) and sew a *normal* seam *between* the two gathering lines.
- **USE:** Attaching a full skirt to a waistband, setting in a puffed sleeve, creating ruffles.

EVALUATION

1. What is the primary function of "fullness techniques"?
2. What is a "dart," and what is its main purpose?
3. Why should you *not* backstitch at the apex of a dart? How should you secure it instead?
4. What is the main difference between a "dart" and a "tuck"?
5. Describe the 3-step machine process for creating "gathers."

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Get a piece of paper. Draw a large dart (a 15cm triangle). Cut it out. Fold the dart legs together and tape them. Describe what happened to the flat paper.
2. **Practical:** On a 30x30cm piece of scrap fabric:
 - (a) Sew three **Pin Tucks**.
 - (b) On the other side, sew two parallel lines of *long stitches*. Pull the bobbin threads to create a 10cm section of **Gathers**.
3. Write a 150-word report comparing Darts, Tucks, and Gathers. (Hint: Darts *shape*, Tucks *decorate*, Gathers *add volume*).
4. Draw a diagram of a simple skirt pattern. Show where you would place the **waist darts**.
5. Define: Apex (of a dart), Dart Intake, Pucker, Pin Tuck, Bobbin Thread.

WEEK 8: FULLNESS TECHNIQUES II

TOPIC: PLEATS, SMOCKING, SHIRRING

INTRODUCTION

This week, we continue our study of how to control fullness (the 3D shape) in garments, moving on to more advanced and decorative techniques.



1. PLEATS

- **DEFINITION:** A **pleat** is a *folded* piece of fabric. Unlike a tuck (which is stitched down), a pleat is usually only stitched *at the top* (e.g., at the waistband) and the fold hangs free, creating structured fullness.

- **PARTS OF A PLEAT:**

- **Pleat Depth:** The amount of fabric *inside* the fold.
- **Pleat Spacing:** The distance *between* the pleats.

- **TYPES OF PLEATS:**

- **A. KNIFE PLEAT:**

- **Description:** The simplest pleat. A series of single folds, all facing in the *same direction*.
- **Use:** School uniform skirts, kilts, traditional skirts.

- **B. BOX PLEAT:**

- **Description:** Created by two knife pleats turned *away* from each other. (i.e., a fold on the left and a fold on the right that meet at the back).
- **Use:** On skirts, jumpers, or the back of a man's shirt.

- **C. INVERTED PLEAT:**

- **Description:** The *opposite* of a box pleat. It is two knife pleats turned *towards* each other, meeting at a center line.
- **Use:** Often used as a single pleat in the center-front or center-back of a skirt to add moving room.

2. SMOCKING

- **DEFINITION:** **Smocking** is an *embroidery technique* that is sewn *over* pre-gathered fabric to hold the gathers in place.

- **FUNCTION:** It is both **functional** (it creates elasticity) and **highly decorative**.

- **HOW IT'S DONE:**

- a. **Dot Grid:** A grid of dots is transferred onto the *wrong side* of the fabric.
- b. **Gathering:** A long running stitch is sewn by hand, picking up each dot. The threads are pulled to create tight, parallel rows of gathers.
- c. **Embroidery:** The decorative stitches (e.g., cable stitch, honeycomb stitch, diamond stitch) are then sewn on the *right side* of the fabric, working over the gathered "pleats."

- **USE:** Traditionally used on the yokes of children's dresses ("smocks"), blouses, and cuffs.

3. SHIRRING

- **DEFINITION:** Shirring is a technique that uses **elastic thread** in the bobbin to automatically create *elasticated gathers*.
- **FUNCTION:** To create a stretchy, body-hugging section of a garment that is also decorative.
- **HOW IT'S DONE:**
 - a. **The Bobbin:** The **elastic thread** is *wound by hand* onto the bobbin. (Do not stretch it as you wind).
 - b. **The Machine:** The top thread is normal (matching) thread. The machine is set to its **longest stitch length** (e.g., 4 or 5).
 - c. **Sewing:** You sew parallel lines (RST). The elastic bobbin thread automatically "gathers up" the fabric as you sew. The more lines you sew, the stretchier it becomes.
- **USE:** Very common on the bodices of sundresses, on waistbands, and on cuffs.

COMPARISON OF FULLNESS TECHNIQUES

Technique	Function	How it's made	Look
Darts	Shaping (Removes fabric)	Sewn V-shape	Structured, fitted
Tucks	Decorative (Adds texture)	Stitched-down folds	Neat, parallel lines
Gathers	Volume (Adds soft fullness)	2 lines of long stitches, pulled	Soft, full, feminine
Pleats	Volume (Adds structured fullness)	Folded, pressed, stitched at top	Sharp, angular, structured
Smocking	Elasticity & Decorative	Embroidery sewn <i>over</i> gathers	Textured, honeycomb, elastic
Shirring	Elasticity & Gathers	Elastic thread in the bobbin	Stretchy, gathered lines

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between a "Tuck" (from Week 6) and a "Pleat"?
2. Name and describe two types of pleats.
3. What is "Smocking"? Is it a gathering technique or an embroidery technique?
4. What is "Shirring," and what special material does it require in the bobbin?
5. What is the main *function* of shirring on a garment?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Get a piece of paper (e.g., A4). Fold and tape it to create (a) a set of **Knife Pleats** and (b) a **Box Pleat**.
2. Research and draw a diagram of a **Box Pleat** and an **Inverted Pleat**. What is their relationship?
3. Research and draw a diagram of "Shirring," showing the elastic bobbin thread and the normal top thread.
4. What is the main difference between "Gathers" (from Week 6) and "Shirring"?
5. Find a picture of a garment that uses **smocking**. In one paragraph, describe where it is used on the garment and the effect it creates.

WEEK 9: PRESSING TECHNIQUES

INTRODUCTION

This week, we revisit a critical topic from First Term: **Pressing**. In professional garment making, it is said that you spend **50% of your time sewing and 50% of your time pressing**.

Pressing is *not* the same as ironing. Pressing is a *construction technique*. You **must** "sew a seam, press a seam" to get a flat, crisp, professional result.



RECAP: PRESSING VS. IRONING

- **IRONING:** This is the back-and-forth, sliding motion you use *after* a garment is washed to remove wrinkles.
- **PRESSING:** This is a **lifting and placing** motion. You place the iron down, hold for a few seconds (often with steam), *lift* the iron, and move to the next spot.
 - **Why?** Sliding (ironing) a seam during construction can **stretch** the fabric, warp the grainline, and make your pieces not fit together. Pressing *sets* the stitches and *shapes* the fabric without stretching it.

ESSENTIAL PRESSING TOOLS AND THEIR USE

1. THE IRON (STEAM/DRY)

- **Function:** The tool that delivers heat and steam.
- **Technique:**
 - **Temperature Setting:** This is *critical*. You must match the temperature to the **fibre** (from Week 8, 1st Term).
 - **High (Cotton/Linen):** High heat is needed for these fibres.
 - **Medium (Wool/Polyester):** High heat will *scorch* wool or *melt* polyester.
 - **Low (Silk/Nylon/Acrylic):** These fibres will melt *instantly* on high heat.
 - **Steam:** Steam relaxes fibres, making it easier to press a sharp crease.

2. THE PRESSING CLOTH

- **Description:** A piece of lightweight, clean cloth (e.g., scrap cotton, muslin, or a silk organza).
- **Function:** It is a *protective barrier* placed **between the iron and the fashion fabric**.
- **Uses:**
 - a. **To Prevent "Shine":** Pressing dark or synthetic fabrics (like polyester or wool suits) directly with a hot iron will make them "shiny." A press cloth prevents this.
 - b. **To Prevent Scorching/Melting:** It protects delicate fabrics (like silk or nylon) from the iron's direct, harsh heat.

- c. **To Prevent Water Spots:** It absorbs any drips from the steam iron.
 - o **Rule:** A pressing cloth is **essential** when pressing on the *right side* of a garment.

3. THE TAILOR'S HAM (PRESSING HAM)

- **Description:** A firmly packed, "ham-shaped" cushion. It has two sides: a wool side (for wools) and a cotton side (for cottons/linens).
- **Function:** A "curved ironing board." It is used to press **curved areas** of a garment.
- **Technique:**
 - a. You cannot press a curved seam (like a bust dart or a princess seam) on a flat ironing board; it will flatten and pucker the curve.
 - b. You place the curved part of the garment (e.g., the bust, the hip, the shoulder cap) *over* the ham.
 - c. You press the seam open on this curved surface, using steam.
- **Result:** This sets the 3D shape into the fabric, making it fit the body.

4. THE SEAM ROLL (SAUSAGE)

- **Description:** A long, firmly packed tube (like a "sausage").
- **Function:** Used to press long, narrow seams *open* in areas that are hard to reach, like **sleeves** or **trouser legs**.
- **Technique:**
 - a. You slide the seam roll *inside* the sleeve.
 - b. You open the seam allowance with your fingers and press it flat on the roll.
- **Why?** This allows you to press *only the seam* without the seam allowance leaving a visible ridge (a "press mark") on the outside of the sleeve.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between "pressing" and "ironing"?
2. What are the three main functions of a "Pressing Cloth"?
3. What is a "Tailor's Ham" used for, and why can't you use a flat ironing board for the same task?

4. What is a "Seam Roll" used for?
5. What will happen if you press a polyester (synthetic) fabric with the iron set to the "Cotton" (high) setting?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Find a curved part of a garment in your home (e.g., the shoulder of a shirt, the bust of a dress).
 - (a) Make a "makeshift" Tailor's Ham by rolling up a thick towel firmly.
 - (b) Place the garment's curve over the towel and practice pressing it.
 - (c) Write one paragraph describing how this felt different from pressing on a flat board.
2. **Practical:** Find a garment made of a dark fabric (e.g., black cotton trousers, a school uniform).
 - (a) Press one small area *with* a pressing cloth (a scrap of cotton).
 - (b) Press another small area *without* a pressing cloth.
 - (c) Describe the difference. Did you see a "shine"?
3. Write a 200-word essay on the topic: "Why We Must 'Press As We Sew'."
4. Draw and label a **Tailor's Ham** and a **Seam Roll**.
5. Find an iron. List the different fibre settings on its temperature dial.

WEEK 10: PRACTICAL: SEWING SIMPLE ARTICLES

TOPIC: HANDKERCHIEF, APRON, PILLOWCASE

INTRODUCTION

This week is a **synthesis project**. The goal is to combine *all* the skills you have learned in the first and second terms into a single, finished, practical item.



This project will test your ability to:

- **Measure & Cut** accurately (1st Term, Wk 3)
- **Use the Sewing Machine** safely (1st Term, Wk 4 & Wk 6)

- **Sew Straight Stitches** (2nd Term, Wk 3)
- **Sew Seams** (2nd Term, Wk 4)
- **Apply Seam Finishes** (2nd Term, Wk 4)
- **Create Hems** (2nd Term, Wk 2)
- **Press correctly** (2nd Term, Wk 9)

PROJECT 1: HANDKERCHIEF (OR TABLE NAPKIN)

- **Objective:** To practice precision cutting and perfect hemming (by hand or machine).
- **Skills:** Measuring, Cutting, Pressing, Hemming (Slant Stitch or Machine).
- **Materials:** A 30cm x 30cm square of lightweight cotton or chiffon.
- **Process:**
 - a. **Measure & Cut:** Carefully measure and cut a *perfect* 30cm x 30cm square. Use your Tailor's Square to ensure 90-degree corners.
 - b. **Press Hem:** On one edge, fold the raw edge in 0.5cm and press. Fold it 0.5cm *again* (this is a **double-fold hem**) and press. This encloses the raw edge.
 - c. **Miter Corners:** (Advanced) At the corners, fold the fabric diagonally to create a "miter" for a flat, sharp corner.
 - d. **Press** all four sides.
 - e. **Sew:** Secure the hem.
 - **Machine:** "Topstitch" the hem with a straight stitch, sewing very close (1-2mm) to the inner folded edge.
 - **Hand:** Use a **Slant Hemming Stitch** (from Wk 2) for an invisible, high-quality finish.
 - f. **Final Press:** Give the entire handkerchief a final press.

PROJECT 2: SIMPLE PILLOWCASE (BAG STYLE)

- **Objective:** To practice sewing straight seams and applying seam finishes.
- **Skills:** Measuring, Cutting, Plain Seam, Seam Finish (Zigzag or French).

- **Materials:** A large rectangle of cotton or poly-cotton (e.g., 55cm x 110cm for a standard pillow).
- **Process:**
 - a. **Measure & Cut:** Cut the fabric to the correct dimensions.
 - b. **Sew the Hem:** Take *one* of the short (55cm) edges. Create a deep **double-fold hem** (e.g., fold 1cm, press; fold 3cm, press). This will be the "opening" of the pillowcase.
 - c. **Machine Stitch** the hem down.
 - d. **Sew the Seam:** Fold the *entire* piece of fabric in half, **Right Sides Together (RST)**, matching the hemmed edge.
 - e. **Machine Stitch a Plain Seam** along the *bottom* edge and the *side* edge (the two raw edges). Backstitch at the start and end.
 - f. **Finish the Seam:** You now have two raw seam allowances on the *inside* of the pillowcase. They will fray if you don't finish them.
 - **Option A (Zigzag):** Set your machine to a zigzag stitch and sew along the raw edge of both seam allowances.
 - **Option B (French Seam):** If you are using a lightweight fabric, you could use a French Seam (from Wk 4) for a superior, enclosed finish.
 - g. **Final Step:** Turn the pillowcase right-side-out and give it a final press.

PROJECT 3: SIMPLE BIB APRON

- **Objective:** To practice using a simple pattern, sewing curves, and creating/attaching straps.
- **Skills:** Pattern use, cutting, hemming, creating straps, applying fullness (optional).
- **Materials:** 1 meter of sturdy cotton, drill, or "Ankara" fabric.
- **Process:**
 - a. **Pattern:** Draft or use a simple pattern for the main apron "bib."
 - b. **Cut:** Cut 1 x Bib Body. Cut 3 x long strips (e.g., 8cm wide) for the ties (2 for the waist, 1 for the neck loop).

- c. **Hem Bib:** Sew a double-fold hem around the *curved* armhole edges and the *sides* of the bib.
- d. **Create Straps:**
- Fold one long strip in half (RST).
 - Sew a 1cm seam along the long edge.
 - Turn the tube right-side-out (a difficult but important skill).
 - Press the strap flat.
 - Repeat for all 3 straps.
- e. **Attach Straps:**
- Fold the raw ends of the neck strap and topstitch it to the top two corners of the bib.
 - Fold the raw ends of the waist straps and topstitch them securely to the side "waist" corners.
- f. **Final Press:** Press the entire apron.

EVALUATION

1. What is a "double-fold hem," and what is its purpose?
2. For the pillowcase project, why is it important to apply a seam finish to the *inside* seams?
3. Which project is the best for practicing a "French Seam"?
4. What is the most challenging part of making the straps for the apron?
5. What two skills from previous lessons are required to make the apron?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **PRACTICAL:** You *must* make **one** of the three projects (Handkerchief, Pillowcase, or Apron).
2. **DOCUMENTATION:** Submit your finished project.
3. **WRITTEN:** Write a one-page "Production Report" for your project. Your report must include:
 - (a) A list of all materials and tools you used.

- (b) The step-by-step process you followed.
 - (c) A list of all the *skills* you used (e.g., "measuring," "cutting," "plain seam," "hemming").
 - (d) A "self-evaluation": What part was most successful? What part was most difficult?
4. Calculate the total fabric needed for a pillowcase that must finish at 50cm x 70cm. (You will need to add seam allowances and a hem allowance).
 5. Draw the pattern pieces you would need for the simple bib apron (1 bib, 3 straps).



WEEK 11-13: REVISION & EXAMS

REVISION OF ALL SECOND TERM TOPICS

This period is for a comprehensive review of all practical skills and theory covered this term.

- **WEEK 1: TEMPORARY STITCHES**

- **Purpose:** Fitting, guiding, holding.
- **Types:** Even Tacking, Uneven Tacking, Diagonal Tacking, **Tailor's Tacks** (for marking).

- **WEEK 2: PERMANENT HAND STITCHES**

- **Running Stitch:** Simple, for mending/gathering.
- **Backstitch:** Strongest hand stitch (mimics machine).
- **Hemming Stitches:** Slant/Slip (invisible), Blind (most invisible).
- **Oversewing:** Joining finished edges.

- **WEEK 3: MACHINE STITCHES**

- **Lockstitch:** Top thread + Bobbin thread.
- **Straight Stitch:** For seams (Width 0, Length 2.5-3).
- **Zigzag Stitch:** For seam finishes and stretch fabrics (Width 1-5).
- **Tension:** The key to a balanced stitch.

- **WEEK 4: SEAMS & SEAM FINISHES**

- **Plain Seam:** Sewn RST. Must be *finished*.
- **French Seam:** Sewn WST, then RST. *Enclosed seam* for delicate fabrics.
- **Finishes:** Overlocked (pro), Zigzag (home), Pinking (weak).

- **WEEK 6 & 8: FULLNESS TECHNIQUES**

- **Darts:** V-shape to *remove* fabric for 3D shaping (bust, waist).
- **Tucks:** Stitched *folds* (often decorative).
- **Gathers:** Drawing up fabric with *2 lines of long stitches*.
- **Pleats:** *Folded* fullness, stitched at the top (Knife, Box, Inverted).

- **Smocking:** *Embroidery* over gathers.
- **Shirring:** Using *elastic thread* in the bobbin.
- **WEEK 9: PRESSING**
 - **Pressing vs. Ironing:** "Up-and-Down" (pressing) vs. "Back-and-Forth" (ironing).
 - **Pressing Cloth:** Prevents shine and melting.
 - **Tailor's Ham:** For pressing curves (darts, hips).
 - **Seam Roll:** For pressing tube seams (sleeves, trousers).
- **WEEK 10: PRACTICALS**
 - We combined all skills to make a simple, finished article.

FINAL EXAMINATION

The final examination will consist of two parts:

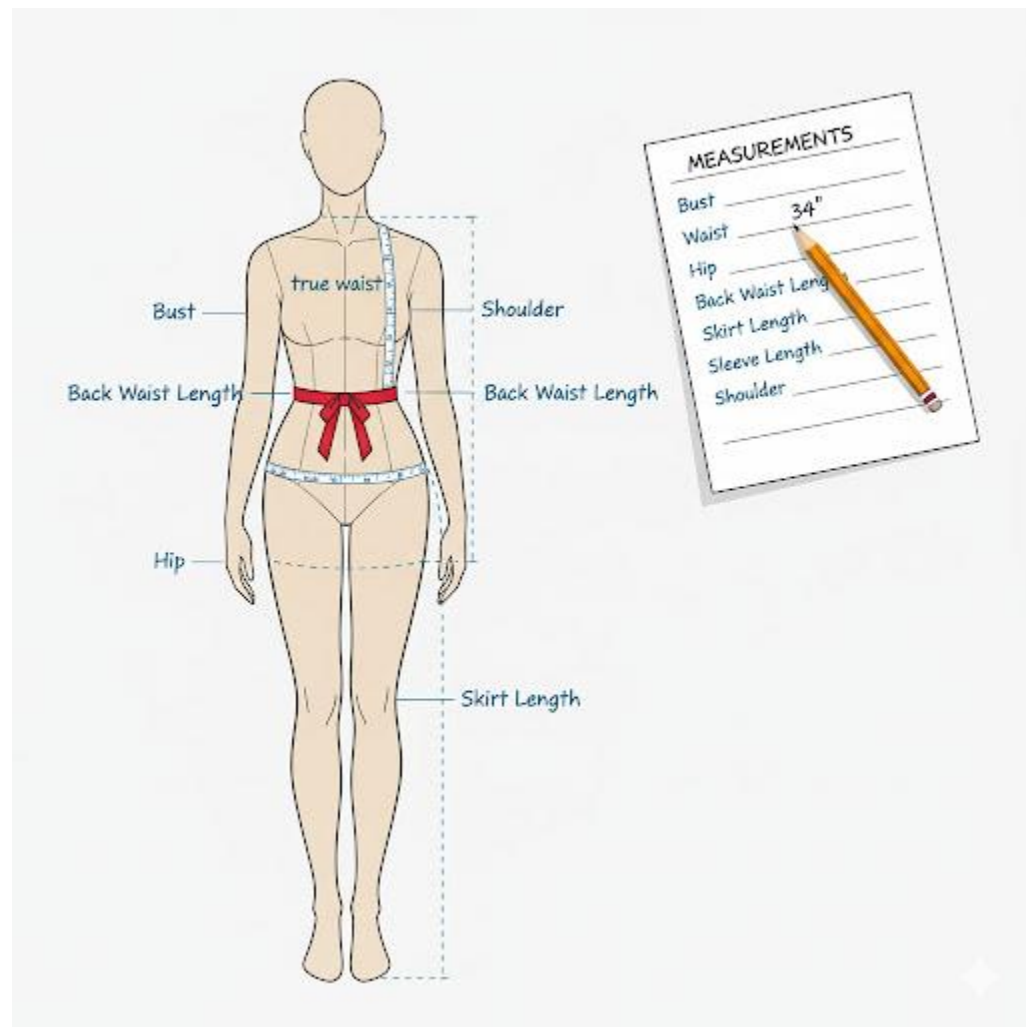
1. **Theory Paper (40%):** Definitions, short-answer questions, "describe the process" questions (e.g., "How do you sew a French Seam?"), and scenario questions (e.g., "What fullness technique is best for a stretchy dress?").
2. **Practical Exam (60%):** A timed test where you will be given fabric and instructions to perform specific tasks, such as:
 - Sew a plain seam with a zigzag finish.
 - Sew a French seam.
 - Sew a dart.
 - Sew a set of gathers.

Here are comprehensive, detailed, and expansive lesson notes for the SS1 Third Term Fashion Design & Garment Making scheme of work.

SS 1 FASHION DESIGN AND GARMENT MAKING LESSON NOTES

THIRD TERM

WEEK 1: BODY MEASUREMENTS



INTRODUCTION

Welcome to the third term. In our previous terms, we learned about the tools, materials, and basic stitches of garment making. Now, we begin the most important and technical part of the craft: **Pattern Drafting** and **Garment Construction**.

The foundation of any well-fitting garment is *not* the sewing; it is the **measurement**. A garment that is sewn perfectly but cut from wrong measurements will *never* fit. A garment sewn with average skill but cut from perfect measurements can still look good.

MEANING AND IMPORTANCE OF BODY MEASUREMENTS

Body Measurements are the exact dimensions (in centimeters or inches) of a human body, taken with a flexible tape measure.

Garment Making is the process of turning a 2-dimensional (flat) piece of fabric into a 3-dimensional (shaped) garment that fits a 3-dimensional body. The body measurements are the "map" that makes this translation possible.

Importance of Accuracy:

1. **Fit:** This is the primary reason. Accurate measurements are the only way to ensure a garment fits the wearer's unique shape, size, and proportions.
2. **Pattern Drafting:** You cannot draft a pattern (a "blueprint" for the garment) without a precise set of measurements.
3. **Economy:** Accurate measurements prevent waste. Cutting a garment too small makes it unusable. Cutting it too large wastes expensive fabric.
4. **Professionalism:** A well-fitting garment is the hallmark of a professional tailor or designer.

TOOLS FOR TAKING MEASUREMENTS

1. **Tape Measure:** A flexible, non-stretch tape, usually 60 inches (150 cm) long. This is the primary tool.
2. **Pencil and Paper (Measurement Chart):** To record the measurements immediately. Never rely on memory.
3. **String or Ribbon:** A length of string or elastic to tie around the person's *true waist*. This establishes the most important horizontal landmark.

PREPARATION FOR TAKING MEASUREMENTS

1. The Subject (Person):

- Should wear simple, form-fitting clothes (e.g., a vest and leggings or light t-shirt). **Never** measure over bulky clothes (like sweaters, jeans, or an *agbada*).
- Should stand naturally, relaxed, and with good posture.
- Should breathe normally (not "suck in" their stomach).
- The subject should be barefoot or in their usual shoes (if measuring for trousers).

2. The Measurer (You):

- Be professional, polite, and explain what you are doing.
- Work efficiently but do not rush.
- Ensure the tape measure is **snug** but **not tight**. A good rule is that you should be able to slip *one finger* (not your whole hand) between the tape and the body.

3. Establishing Landmarks:

- Tie a string or ribbon around the *narrowest part* of the torso. This is the **True Waist**. All vertical measurements (like skirt length) start from here.

HOW TO TAKE KEY MEASUREMENTS

Measurements are divided into three categories: **Girth (Circumference), Vertical, and Horizontal.**

A. GIRTH (CIRCUMFERENCE) MEASUREMENTS

(These are measurements taken around the body. Keep the tape measure parallel to the floor.)

1. **BUST:** Measure around the **fullest part** of the bust. The tape should pass over the nipples and be straight across the back.
2. **WAIST:** Measure around the **narrowest part** of the torso (where you tied the string).
3. **HIP:** Measure around the **fullest part** of the hips (usually 7-9 inches below the waist). Ensure the tape can slide up and down slightly.
4. **NECK:** Measure loosely around the base of the neck.

B. VERTICAL (LENGTH) MEASUREMENTS

(These are measurements taken up and down the body.)

5. **SKIRT LENGTH:** Measure from the **waist** string down to the desired length (e.g., knee, calf, or ankle).
6. **TROUSER LENGTH (OUTSIDE LEG):** Measure from the **waist** string down the *side* of the leg to the desired length.
7. **BODICE LENGTH (BACK WAIST):** Measure from the prominent **bone at the base of the neck** down to the waist string.
8. **SLEEVE LENGTH:** Measure from the **shoulder bone**, over a *slightly bent* elbow, down to the wrist bone.
9. **WAIST-TO-HIP:** The vertical distance from the waist string to the hip level (where you took the hip measurement).

C. HORIZONTAL (WIDTH) MEASUREMENTS

(These are measurements taken across the body, not around.)

10. **BACK WIDTH (ACROSS BACK):** Measure across the back from one armhole-crease to the other (about halfway down the back).
11. **SHOULDER:** Measure from the bone at the *side of the neck* to the *shoulder bone* (where the sleeve would begin).

EVALUATION

1. What is the primary purpose of taking body measurements?
2. Why is it essential to take measurements over form-fitting clothes, not bulky ones?
3. What is the "one-finger rule" for a tape measure?
4. Differentiate between a **Girth** measurement and a **Vertical** measurement, giving one example of each.
5. What is the *first* and most important landmark to establish before taking most measurements?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Find a partner (a family member or classmate). Using a tape measure, take the following 10 measurements: Bust, Waist, Hip, Skirt Length, Sleeve Length, Shoulder, Back Width, Neck, Trouser Length, Waist-to-Hip.
2. **Create a Measurement Chart:** Draw a professional chart on a sheet of paper to record the 10 measurements you took.
3. Write a 200-word report on the problems a tailor would face if they took a "bust" measurement too high (above the fullest part) and a "waist" measurement too loose.
4. Define the following terms: Girth, Vertical, Horizontal, Bodice, Landmark.
5. Draw a simple diagram of the human torso and label the key landmarks: **Bust Point, True Waist, Hip Level.**



WEEK 2: PATTERN DRAFTING I

TOPIC: BASIC BODICE, SKIRT, AND SLEEVE BLOCKS

INTRODUCTION



Last week, we collected our "raw data" (the body measurements). This week, we use that data to create a **Pattern**.

A **Pattern** is a 2-dimensional (2D) "blueprint" or template for a garment. It is the paper "shape" that you will trace onto your fabric before cutting.

A **Block** (or "Sloper") is the most basic, foundational pattern. It has *no* style and *no* seam allowance. It is a perfect 2D copy of the body's shape. From this basic block, you can create *any* style (e.g., a shirt, a jacket, a dress).

METHODS OF PATTERN DRAFTING

1. **FLAT PATTERN DRAFTING:** This is the most common and technical method. It involves using body measurements, rulers, curves, and a pencil to draw the pattern from scratch on a large sheet of paper (pattern paper). This is what we will be learning.
2. **DRAPING:** This is a 3D method. The designer "drapes" and pins fabric directly onto a dress form (mannequin) to create the design, then removes the fabric and flattens it to create the pattern.
3. **FREEHAND CUTTING:** This is a highly advanced skill (common with experienced Nigerian tailors) where the tailor cuts the fabric *directly*, without a paper pattern, using only their eye and a few chalk marks. This is *not* recommended for beginners.

TOOLS FOR PATTERN DRAFTING

- **Pattern Paper (or Brown Paper):** Large sheets for drawing.
- **Pencils (HB and 2H) and Eraser:** For drawing and correcting.
- **Tape Measure:** To measure distances on the pattern.
- **Rulers (Meter Stick):** For long, straight lines.
- **Tailor's Square (L-Square):** Essential for drawing perfect 90° right angles (the "grainline").
- **French Curve:** For drawing all the body's curves (armholes, necklines, hiplines).
- **Tracing Wheel & Carbon Paper:** To copy the pattern.

DRAFTING THE BASIC SKIRT BLOCK (FRONT & BACK)

This is the simplest block to learn. It requires 4 key measurements:

1. **Waist** (e.g., 70cm)
2. **Hip** (e.g., 96cm)
3. **Waist-to-Hip Length** (e.g., 20cm)
4. **Skirt Length** (e.g., 60cm)

Basic Steps (Simplified):

1. **The "Box":** On your paper, draw a rectangle.
 - **Width:** 1/2 of Hip measurement (e.g., $96/2 = 48\text{cm}$)
 - **Length:** Skirt Length (e.g., 60cm)
2. **Divide the Box:** Draw a vertical line down the middle. This separates the **Skirt Front** (1/4 Hip) from the **Skirt Back** (1/4 Hip).
3. **Mark Hip Line:** Measure down from the top (waist) by your "Waist-to-Hip Length" (e.g., 20cm) and draw a horizontal line. This is your **Hip Line**.
4. **Shape the Waist (Darts):** Your 1/2 Hip (48cm) is *wider* than your 1/2 Waist ($70/2 = 35\text{cm}$). The difference ($48 - 35 = 13\text{cm}$) must be *removed* in **darts** and at the side seam.
5. **Draw Darts:** You will draw vertical **darts** (V-shapes) in the Front and Back pieces to "pull in" the fabric at the waist.
6. **Shape the Side Seam:** Use your **French Curve** to draw a smooth, curved line from the new waist (after darts) down to the hip line.

DRAFTING THE BASIC BODICE BLOCK (FRONT & BACK)

This is more complex. It requires measurements like Bust, Waist, Back Width, Shoulder, and Bodice Length.

- **The Concept:** The bodice block is a "map" of the upper torso.
- **The Back:** The Back Block is usually drafted first. It is relatively flat.
- **The Front:** The Front Block is more complex because it must account for the **bust**. It is *always* wider and longer than the Back Block.

- **The Darts:** The Front Block *must* have a **Bust Dart** (a dart coming from the side seam, pointing to the bust apex) to create the 3D "cone" shape needed to fit over the bust. It also has a waist dart.

DRAFTING THE BASIC SLEEVE BLOCK

- **The Concept:** The sleeve is a tube that must fit into the curved "armhole" of the bodice.
- **Measurements Needed:**
 - a. **Armhole Circumference:** (Measured from your finished bodice block).
 - b. **Bicep Circumference.**
 - c. **Sleeve Length.**
- **The "Sleeve Cap":** The hardest part to draft is the curved "cap" at the top of the sleeve. It must be shaped perfectly (using a French Curve) to ease into the armhole without puckering.

EVALUATION

1. What is a "Pattern Block" or "Sloper"?
2. List the three main methods of pattern drafting.
3. What is a "French Curve" used for?
4. What measurements are required to draft a basic skirt block?
5. Why is the Front Bodice block *always* different (wider/longer) from the Back Bodice block?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Using your own measurements from Week 1, draft a **Basic Skirt Block** (Front and Back) on pattern paper.
2. List and draw all the essential tools needed for Flat Pattern Drafting.
3. Write a 200-word report on the differences between "Flat Pattern Drafting" and "Draping."
4. Research "Freehand Cutting." Why is it a "high-risk" method for a beginner?

5. Define: Pattern, Sloper, Grainline, Seam Allowance, Dart Apex.



WEEK 3: PATTERN DRAFTING II

TOPIC: SIMPLE DRESS PATTERNS

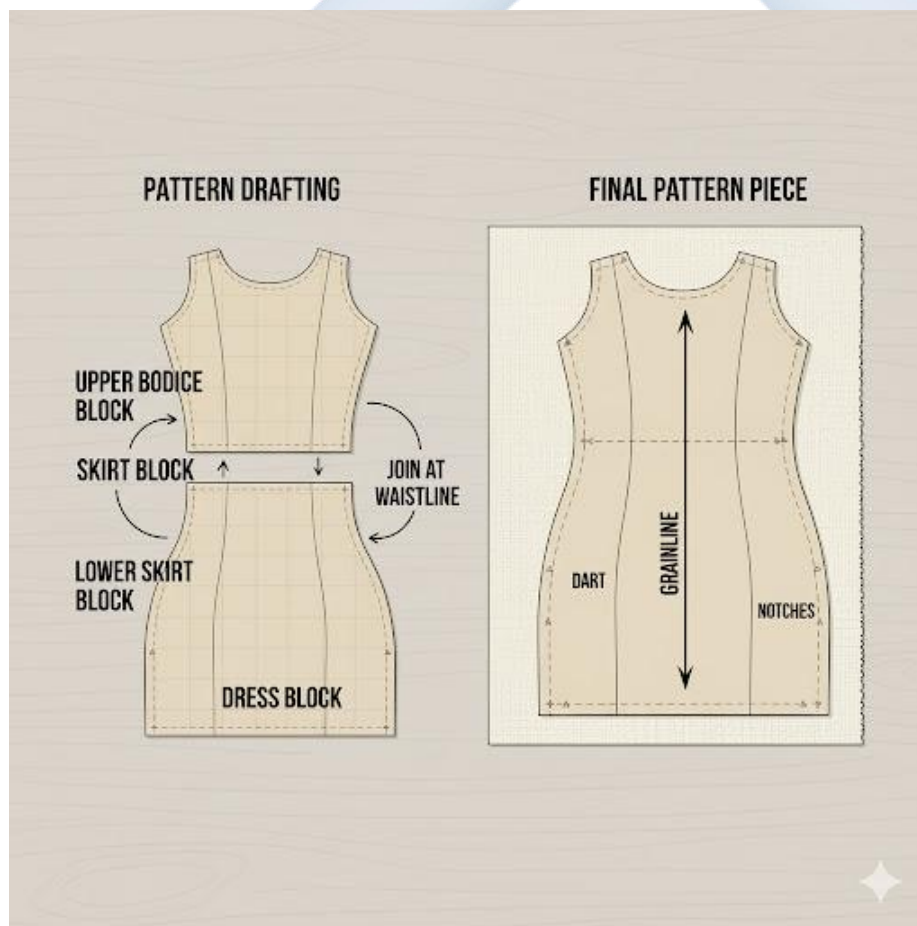
INTRODUCTION

Now that we have our separate "building blocks" (Bodice, Skirt, Sleeve), we can start to combine and adapt them to create a full garment. A **simple dress** is the first step.

A **Simple Dress Pattern** is created by combining the **Bodice Block** and the **Skirt Block**.

There are two primary types of simple dresses:

1. **The Shift Dress:** A loose-fitting dress that hangs straight from the shoulders, with *no* waistline seam. It has very little shaping.
2. **The Sheath Dress:** A fitted dress that follows the body's curves. It *is* shaped by darts (bust, waist) but still has no waistline seam.



ADAPTING THE BASIC BLOCKS (THE "HOW-TO")

We will create a **Simple Sheath Dress** pattern by joining our blocks.

Tools: Bodice Block (Front & Back), Skirt Block (Front & Back), new Pattern Paper, Pencils, Rulers, Tape.

Procedure (Simplified):

1. **Trace the Bodice:** Place your Front Bodice Block on the new paper and trace it.
2. **Trace the Skirt:** Take your Front Skirt Block. *Overlap* the waistline of the skirt on top of the waistline of the bodice.
3. **Align:** Make sure the **Center Front (CF)** lines of both blocks are perfectly aligned in one long, straight line.
4. **Trace** the skirt block.
5. **Result:** You now have one single paper pattern piece: the **DRESS FRONT**.
6. **Smooth the Seam:** Use your French Curve to "smooth" the transition at the side seam, blending the bodice curve into the hip curve.
7. **Repeat:** Do the exact same thing for the **Back Bodice** and **Back Skirt** blocks to create the **DRESS BACK** pattern.

ADDING SEAM ALLOWANCES (THE CRITICAL STEP)

Your "block" is the *exact size of the body*. You cannot sew on this line. You must add **Seam Allowance**—the extra fabric that will be on the *inside* of the garment.

- **Standard Allowance:** The standard seam allowance for seams is **1.5cm** (or 5/8 inch).
- **Hem Allowance:** The allowance at the bottom of the dress is larger, e.g., **3-4cm**.
- **Zipper Allowance:** An extra 2cm is added to the **Center Back** seam to allow for a zipper.
- **Procedure:** Using a tape measure or seam gauge, carefully measure and draw a *new line* 1.5cm *outside* of your original block line. This new, outer line is your **CUTTING LINE**.

PATTERN MARKINGS (THE "LANGUAGE" OF PATTERNS)

A pattern is a silent instruction manual. These markings tell the sewer *how* to build the garment.

- **GRAINLINE:**
 - **What:** A long, straight line with arrows at both ends, drawn on every pattern piece.
 - **Rule:** This line **MUST** be placed **parallel to the selvedge** (the finished edge) of the fabric.
 - **Why?** This ensures the garment hangs correctly (on the "straight grain") and doesn't twist or stretch.
- **NOTCHES (BALANCE MARKS):**
 - **What:** Small "T" shapes or triangles drawn on the seam lines.
 - **Why?** They are "match-up" points. For example, a notch on the back of a sleeve must match a notch on the back of the armhole. This ensures you are sewing the correct pieces together.
- **DARTS:** The V-shape is drawn clearly, with the apex marked.
- **FOLD LINE:**
 - **What:** A bracketed line on the "Center Front" or "Center Back."
 - **Why?** This tells you to place *this edge* on the **fold** of the fabric. This creates one large, seamless "Front" piece. You *do not* cut this line.
- **CUTTING LINE:** The outer line (with seam allowance) that you *cut*.
- **STITCHING LINE:** The inner line (the original block) that you *sew* on.

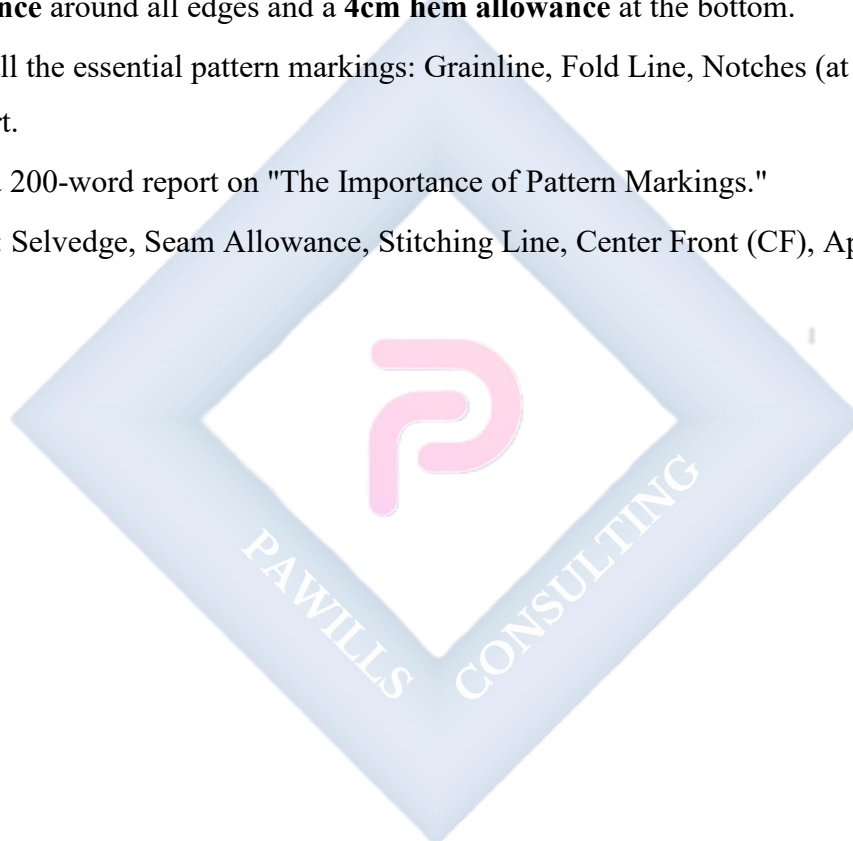
EVALUATION

1. What two basic blocks are combined to create a simple dress pattern?
2. What is the main difference between a "Shift Dress" and a "Sheath Dress"?
3. What is "Seam Allowance," and why is it necessary?

4. What is the **Grainline**? What part of the *fabric* must it be parallel to?
5. What are "Notches," and what is their purpose?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Take your Front Bodice Block and Front Skirt Block (from Week 2). On a new sheet of pattern paper, tape them together at the waistline (aligning the Center Fronts) to create a **Dress Front Block**.
2. **Practical:** On the Dress Front Block you just created, practice adding a **1.5cm seam allowance** around all edges and a **4cm hem allowance** at the bottom.
3. Draw all the essential pattern markings: Grainline, Fold Line, Notches (at waist/hip), and the Dart.
4. Write a 200-word report on "The Importance of Pattern Markings."
5. Define: Selvedge, Seam Allowance, Stitching Line, Center Front (CF), Apex.



WEEK 4: PATTERN ALTERATION

INTRODUCTION

You have now drafted a "standard" pattern block based on your measurements. But what if your body is not "standard"? (No one's is!)

- Maybe your bust is larger than the "standard" draft for your waist?
- Maybe your back is shorter than the standard?
- Maybe you want to add fullness for a flared skirt?

Pattern Alteration is the technical process of *changing* a basic pattern to fit a specific figure variation or to create a new style.

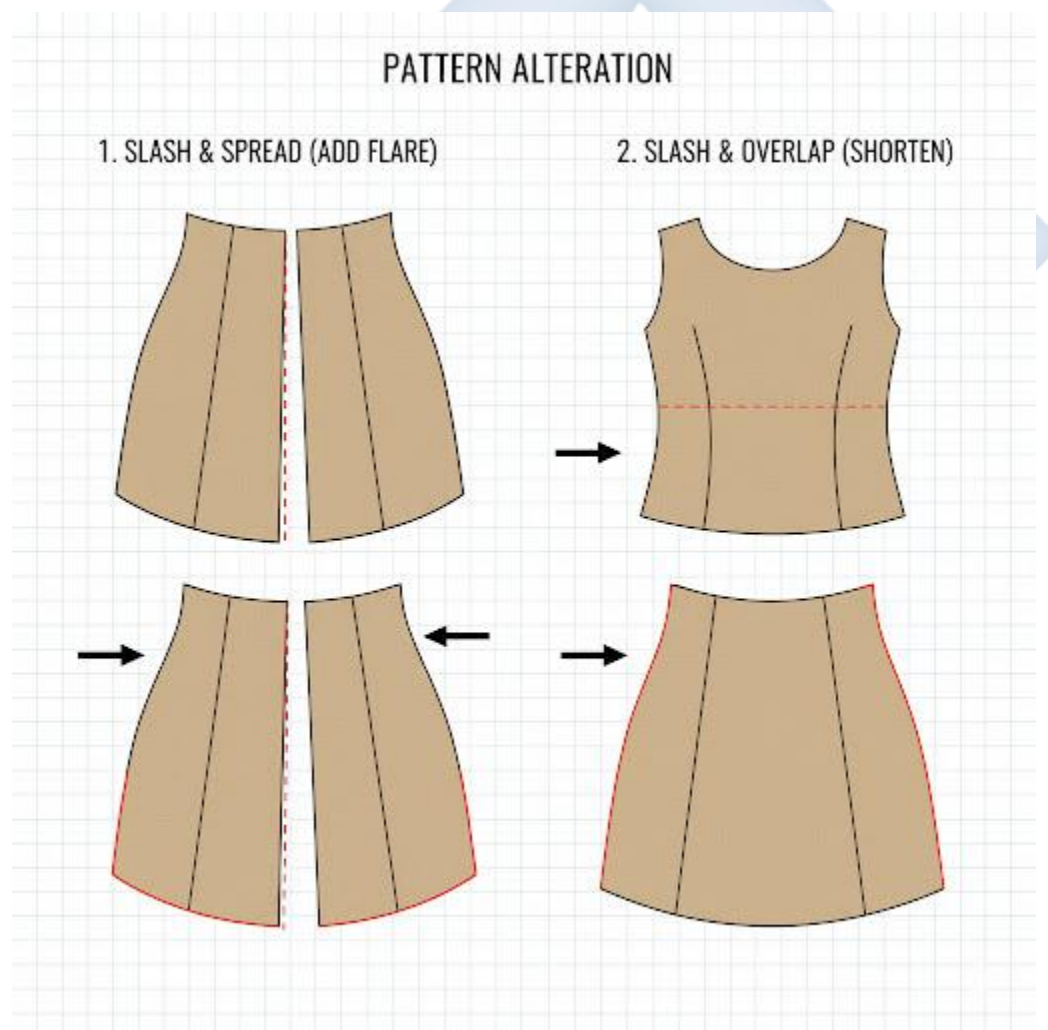


FIGURE VARIATIONS

Patterns are drafted for a "standard" figure. Common variations include:

- **Large or Small Bust** (with an average waist/hip)
- **Large or Small Hips** (with an average bust/waist)
- **Long or Short Waist** (bodice length is too short/long)
- **Sway Back** (extra fabric pooling at the small of the back)
- **Flat Seat** (fabric sags at the back of a skirt)

TWO MAIN ALTERATION METHODS

These are the "golden rules" for altering a pattern *without* distorting its shape.

1. "SLASH AND SPREAD" METHOD

- **PURPOSE:** To **ADD** fullness or space to a pattern (e.g., for a larger bust, larger hip, or to add a "flare" to a skirt).
- **PROCEDURE:**
 - a. Draw lines on your pattern where you need to add fullness.
 - b. **SLASH:** Cut *along* these lines, but *not* all the way to the edge. Leave a tiny "hinge" of paper.
 - c. **SPREAD:** Place the pattern on a new piece of paper and *spread* (open) the slashed sections by the amount you need to add (e.g., spread 2cm).
 - d. **TAPE:** Tape the pattern down in its new, spread-out shape.
 - e. **BLEND:** Redraw the cut lines (e.g., the side seam) to be smooth again.

2. "SLASH AND OVERLAP" METHOD (OR "SLASH AND FOLD")

- **PURPOSE:** To **REMOVE** excess fullness or space from a pattern (e.g., for a small bust, a flat seat, or a sway back).
- **PROCEDURE:**
 - a. Draw lines on your pattern where you need to remove fullness.
 - b. **SLASH:** Cut along these lines (again, leave a hinge).

- c. **OVERLAP:** *Overlap* the slashed sections by the amount you need to remove (e.g., overlap 2cm).
- d. **TAPE:** Tape the pattern down in its new, overlapped shape.
- e. **BLEND:** Redraw the cut lines to be smooth.

SPECIFIC ALTERATIONS (EXAMPLES)

A. LENGTHENING OR SHORTENING (SKIRT, TROUSER, OR BODICE)

- **Problem:** The pattern is too long or too short for you.
- **Solution (Shortening):**
 - a. Draw a horizontal line across the pattern (in the middle, *not* at the hip or hem).
 - b. Fold the pattern along this line to *remove* the excess length (e.g., fold a 3cm "pleat" into the paper).
 - c. Tape and "blend" (true) the side seams.
- **Solution (Lengthening):**
 - a. **Slash** the pattern horizontally.
 - b. **Spread** the two pieces apart by the amount needed (e.g., 3cm).
 - c. Tape to a new piece of paper and blend the side seams.

B. FULL BUST ADJUSTMENT (FBA)

- **Problem:** The pattern fits your waist, but is too tight *only* at the bust.
- **Solution ("Slash and Spread"):**
 - a. Draw lines on the bodice *through* the bust apex.
 - b. **Slash** the pattern.
 - c. **Spread** the pattern pieces. This adds width *and* length *only* at the bust area.
 - d. This also makes the waist dart *bigger*, which "uses up" the extra waist fabric you just created.
 - e. This is the *correct* way. Just "grading up" the whole pattern would make the shoulders and waist too big.

C. ADDING FLARE TO A SKIRT

- **Problem:** You have a straight skirt block but want to make a flared (A-line) skirt.
- **Solution ("Slash and Spread"):DRAFTING**
 - a. Take your straight skirt block.
 - b. **Slash** vertically from the hem up to (but not through) the hip line.
 - c. **Spread** these sections at the *hem* to add fullness.
 - d. The waist stays the same, but the hem "flares" out.

EVALUATION

1. What is the purpose of pattern alteration?
2. What is the "Slash and Spread" method used for?
3. What is the "Slash and Overlap" method used for?
4. How would you alter a skirt pattern that is too *short* for you?
5. What does "FBA" stand for, and when is it used?

ASSIGNMENT

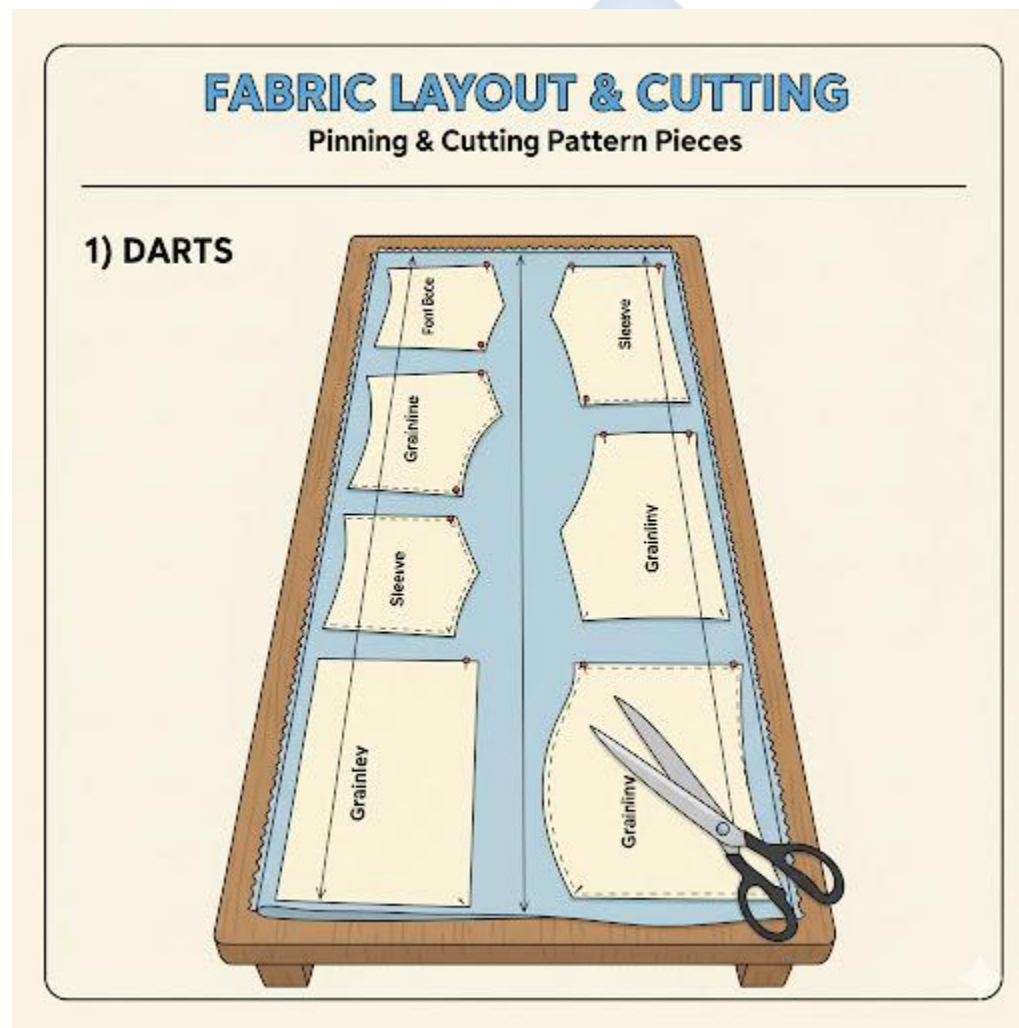
1. **Practical:** Take your **Basic Skirt Block** (from Week 2).
 - (a) Perform a "**Slash and Spread**" alteration to add 8cm of flare to the hem.
 - (b) Tape it to a new piece of paper and redraw the hem and side seams.
2. **Practical:** Take your **Basic Sleeve Block**.
 - (a) Perform an alteration to *shorten* the sleeve by 5cm.
3. Write a 200-word report explaining *why* a person with a large bust *must* do an FBA, and why just cutting a larger size (e.g., size 16 instead of 12) will *not* work.
4. Draw a step-by-step diagram showing how to **lengthen** a trouser pattern.
5. Define: Figure Variation, Slash, Spread, Hinge, Blending (Trueing).

WEEK 6: FABRIC LAYOUT & CUTTING

INTRODUCTION

This is the "point of no return." All your careful measuring and drafting can be ruined in 5 minutes by a bad fabric layout.

Fabric Layout is the process of *arranging* your paper pattern pieces on your fabric *before* you cut. A correct layout ensures the garment hangs properly, the patterns match, and you don't waste fabric.



STEP 1: PREPARING THE FABRIC

You must *never* cut fabric straight from the bag.

1. PRE-WASHING (SHRINKING):

- **Why?** Most natural fibres (especially cotton and linen) will **shrink** the *first* time they are washed.
- **The Rule:** You must wash and dry your fabric *before* you cut it. If you don't, you will sew a perfect-fitting garment, and it will be *too small* after the first wash.

2. PRESSING:

- The fabric must be perfectly **ironed**. Any wrinkles or creases will make your cut pieces inaccurate.

3. IDENTIFYING THE FABRIC GRAIN:

- Find the **Selvedge (or Selvage)**. This is the tightly woven, "finished" edge of the fabric that does not fray. This edge runs parallel to the **Lengthwise Grain**.

UNDERSTANDING FABRIC GRAIN (THE "DNA" OF FABRIC)

Fabric is woven from two sets of threads.

• LENGTHWISE GRAIN (WARP):

- The threads that run *parallel* to the selvedge.
- This is the **strongest** direction of the fabric with the *least* amount of stretch.
- **RULE:** Garments are *always* cut with the "length" (e.g., head-to-toe) running along the lengthwise grain.

• CROSSWISE GRAIN (WEFT):

- The threads that run *across* the fabric, from selvedge to selvedge.
- This direction has a *slight* amount of stretch.

• BIAS:

- The **45-degree angle** *between* the lengthwise and crosswise grains.
- This is the **stretchiest** part of the fabric.
- **Use:** We cut strips "on the bias" to make facings for curved necklines, as it can stretch to fit the curve.

THE GOLDEN RULE: THE GRAINLINE ARROW

- Your pattern pieces have a long arrow on them labeled "**Grainline.**"
- **THE RULE:** When you lay your pattern on the fabric, this arrow **MUST** be perfectly **parallel to the selvedge**.
- **How to check:** Measure the distance from *one end* of the arrow to the selvedge (e.g., 20cm). Then measure the distance from the *other end* of the arrow to the selvedge. It *must* also be 20cm.

NAP / PILE / ONE-WAY PRINTS

- **NAP/PILE:** This refers to fabrics with a *texture* that goes in one direction (e.g., **Velvet, Corduroy, Suede**). If you brush it one way, it's smooth; the other way, it's rough.
- **ONE-WAY PRINT:** This refers to a fabric pattern that has a clear "up" and "down" (e.g., flowers that grow upwards, or the faces on *Ankara*).
- **THE RULE:** For *all* napped or one-way-print fabrics, all your pattern pieces **MUST** be laid out facing the **SAME DIRECTION**.
- **Disaster:** If you cut one trouser leg "up" and one "down" on velvet, they will look like two different colors (one light, one dark).

FABRIC LAYOUT METHODS (FOLDS)

Your layout depends on your pattern and fabric width.

- **LENGTHWISE FOLD:**
 - **How:** Fold the fabric in half, bringing the two **selvedges together**.
 - **Use:** The most common layout. Used for pieces that are "Cut on Fold" (like a Dress Front) and for cutting pairs (like sleeves).
- **CROSSWISE FOLD:**
 - **How:** Fold the fabric in half, bringing the two **cut edges** together.
 - **Use:** For pattern pieces that are *very wide*.

- **OPEN LAYOUT:**

- **How:** Do *not* fold the fabric. Lay it out as a single layer.
- **Use:** For asymmetrical designs or when you need to "fussy cut" a pattern (e.g., placing a large flower in the center of a bodice).

PINNING AND CUTTING

1. Pinning:

- Lay all pieces on the fabric *before* cutting anything.
- Pin the **grainline** first.
- Pin the corners, then pin every 10-15cm.

2. Cutting:

- Use long, sharp **Dressmaker's Shears**.
- Keep the fabric **flat** on the table. *Do not* lift the fabric up to cut it.
- Cut with long, smooth strokes. Use the *tip* of the shears for curves.
- Cut *all* notches **outward** (as little triangles), not inward.
- **Do not** cut the "fold" line.

EVALUATION

1. Why is it essential to pre-wash fabric before cutting?
2. What is the "Selvedge"?
3. What is the "Bias," and what is its main characteristic?
4. What is the "Golden Rule" for laying out a pattern piece with a grainline arrow?
5. What is "Nap," and what is the rule for laying out pattern pieces on napped fabric?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **Practical:** Take a 1-meter piece of fabric (Ankara is perfect).
 - (a) Identify the **Selvedge**.
 - (b) Identify the **Lengthwise Grain** and **Crosswise Grain**.
 - (c) Pull on all three (lengthwise, crosswise, bias). Describe the difference in stretch.

2. **Practical:** On the same fabric, practice the two main folds: **Lengthwise Fold** and **Crosswise Fold**.
3. Draw a diagram of a piece of fabric, showing the selvedge. Draw a pattern piece placed on it *incorrectly* (off-grain) and one placed *correctly*.
4. Find a "napped" fabric in your home (e.g., a velvet cushion, a towel, corduroy trousers). Describe what happens when you brush it "up" vs. "down."
5. Define: Warp, Weft, Bias, Selvedge, Fray, Fussy Cut.



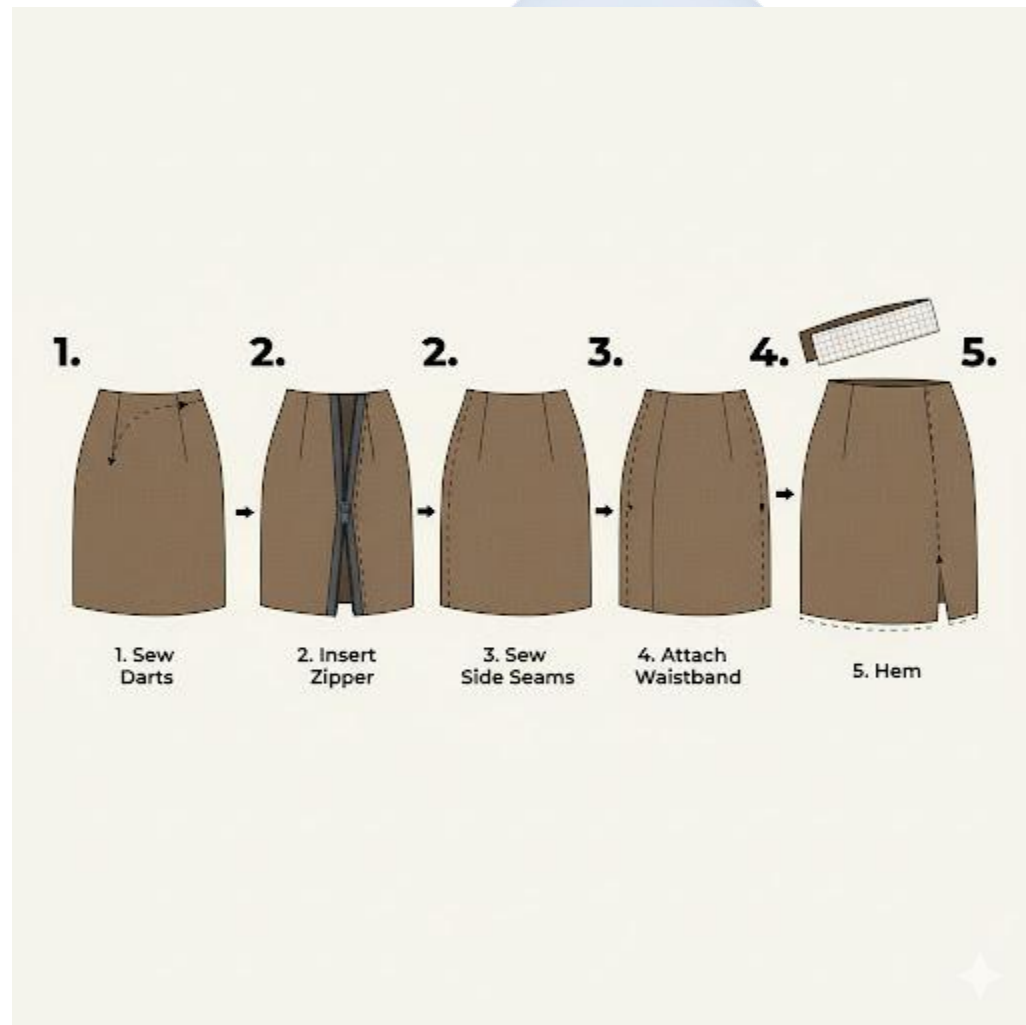
WEEK 8: GARMENT CONSTRUCTION I (SKIRT)

INTRODUCTION

This week, we begin **Garment Construction**. This is the step-by-step process of *sewing* the cut fabric pieces into a finished garment.

The most important rule of construction is the **Order of Operations (or Order of Construction)**. Sewing a garment is like building a house: you *must* build the foundation before you put on the roof. If you sew the parts in the wrong order, it will be impossible to finish.

We will focus on the construction of a simple **Straight Skirt**.



ORDER OF CONSTRUCTION: STRAIGHT SKIRT

This is the standard, professional order for assembling a simple skirt with a zipper and a waistband.

1. **Stay-stitch Waistline** (Optional but recommended): Sew a line of straight stitches 1.3cm (just inside the seam allowance) around the waist edge. This *prevents the curve from stretching* while you work.
2. **Sew Darts (or Tucks):**
 - Fold, pin, and sew all darts on the Skirt Front and Skirt Back pieces.
 - **Press** all darts (vertical darts are pressed towards the Center Front/Center Back).
3. **Insert the Zipper:**
 - Most commonly inserted into the **Center Back (CB)** seam.
 - Finish the seam allowances of the CB seam (e.g., with a zigzag).
 - Pin the zipper in place and sew it using a **Zipper Foot** on your machine.
4. **Sew Side Seams:**
 - Place the Skirt Front and Skirt Back **Right Sides Together (RST)**.
 - Pin and sew the *left* and *right* side seams.
5. **Finish Seam Allowances:**
 - Finish the raw edges of the side seams (e.g., zigzag or overlock).
 - **Press** the seam allowances (usually pressed *open* or *towards the back*).
6. **Prepare and Attach the Waistband:**
 - A waistband is a long, rectangular piece.
 - **Interface:** Iron **interfacing** (a stiffening fabric) to the wrong side of the waistband.
 - Sew the waistband (RST) to the top edge of the skirt.
 - Press the seam *up* into the waistband.
 - Fold, press, and "stitch in the ditch" or "topstitch" the waistband to finish it.
7. **Sew the Hem:**
 - Create a double-fold hem at the bottom of the skirt.

- **Press** the hem.
- Secure the hem, either with a **machine topstitch** (for a casual skirt) or a **hand-sewn blind hem stitch** (for a professional finish).

8. Final Press & Finish:

- Sew the button or hook-and-bar closure *above* the zipper on the waistband.
- Give the entire garment a final, thorough press.

VARIATIONS: GATHERED & FLARED SKIRTS

• GATHERED SKIRT CONSTRUCTION:

- The construction is *simpler* but the technique is different.
- **Order:**
 - Sew side seams (RST).
 - Finish seam allowances.
 - Sew Gathering Stitches:** Sew two parallel lines of *long stitches* (stitch length 5) along the *entire* top (waist) edge of the skirt.
 - Attach Waistband:** Pin the flat waistband to the skirt. **Pull the bobbin threads** of the gathering stitches until the skirt "gathers up" and fits the waistband. Distribute gathers evenly.
 - Stitch the waistband in place.
 - Insert zipper (optional, as some gathered skirts are pull-on).
 - Sew hem.

• FLARED SKIRT (A-LINE) CONSTRUCTION:

- This is almost identical to a **Straight Skirt**.
- The *only* difference is the **hem**. Because the hem is *curved* (not straight), it is more difficult.
- A deep hem will not lie flat. You must use a **narrow double-fold hem** (e.g., 0.5cm) or a **bias-tape facing** to get a clean, pucker-free finish.

EVALUATION

1. What is "Order of Construction," and why is it important?
2. What is the very first sewing step in constructing a straight skirt?
3. What tool (machine foot) is required to insert a zipper neatly?
4. How are darts pressed (in which direction)?
5. What is the main difference in constructing a *gathered* skirt versus a *straight* skirt?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write out the full **Order of Construction** (in 8 clear steps) for a simple straight skirt with a back zipper and a waistband.
2. Research and write a 200-word report on the different types of **Zippers** (e.g., "Regular," "Invisible," "Separating") and what each is used for.
3. **Practical:** On scrap fabric, practice sewing the 2 parallel lines of *gathering stitches* and pulling them to create gathers.
4. Define: Stay-stitching, Interfacing, Waistband, Zipper Foot, Topstitching.
5. Why is it difficult to hem a flared (curved) skirt? What is the best way to do it?

WEEK 9: GARMENT CONSTRUCTION II (BLOUSE/SHIRT)

INTRODUCTION

This week, we move to a more complex garment: the **Blouse** (for women) or **Shirt** (for men).

A blouse/shirt is more complex than a skirt because it involves:

- A **neckline** finish (like a collar or a facing).
- **Sleeves** that must be "set in" to an armhole.
- **Openings** (button plackets).

The **Order of Construction** is absolutely critical. The golden rule is: "**Work flat for as long as possible.**" This means you do all the "fussy" work (like adding collars and pockets) *before* you sew the side seams.



ORDER OF CONSTRUCTION: SIMPLE SHIRT/BLOUSE

This is the standard, professional order for assembling a simple button-front shirt with a collar and set-in sleeves.

1. PREPARE SMALL PARTS (THE "TRIMS"):

- **Collar:** Sew the Top Collar and Under Collar together (RST). Turn, press, and topstitch.
- **Cuffs:** (If a long-sleeve shirt). Sew, turn, and press the cuffs.
- **Pocket:** Prepare the chest pocket (hem the top, press the seam allowances under).

2. PREPARE THE FRONT AND BACK BODICE:

- **Interface:** Iron interfacing onto the **Button Placket** area (the front opening) and the **Collar Stand**.
- **Darts:** Sew and press any darts (bust/waist) on the Front and Back pieces.
- **Pockets:** **Topstitch** the prepared chest pocket onto the Shirt Front. (This is *easy* now, but *impossible* later).

3. JOIN SHOULDERS & ADD COLLAR:

- Place Front and Back **RST**.
- Sew the **Shoulder Seams**.
- Press seams open.
- **Attach Collar:** Pin the prepared collar to the neckline. Stitch it in place. This is a complex curved seam.

4. ATTACH (SET IN) THE SLEEVES:

- **This is the hardest part.**
- With the shirt *still flat*, pin the curved **Sleeve Cap** into the curved **Armhole** (RST).
- The sleeve cap is *larger* than the armhole, so you must "**ease**" the fullness in without creating puckers.

- Stitch the sleeve in.

5. SEW THE "BIG" SEAM (SIDE & UNDERARM):

- Now, fold the *entire* garment (RST) at the shoulder seam.
- Pin all the way from the **sleeve cuff** (wrist) up to the **underarm**, "pivot" the fabric, and continue pinning all the way down the **side seam** to the bottom hem.
- Sew this one, long continuous seam.
- Finish and press this seam.

6. FINISH EDGES:

- **Cuffs:** (If long-sleeve). Attach the prepared cuffs to the sleeve-ends.
- **Hem:** Sew the bottom hem of the shirt.

7. CLOSURES (BUTTONS & BUTTONHOLES):

- **This is the *very last* step.**
- **Rule: Buttonholes** (on the right side for women, left for men) are sewn *first*.
- **Buttons** are sewn on *second*, aligned with the buttonholes.

8. FINAL PRESS:

- Give the entire garment a final, professional press, using a pressing ham for the sleeve caps and darts.

EVALUATION

1. What is the "golden rule" of garment construction (hint: "Work flat...")?
2. What is the *first* general step in sewing a shirt (e.g., sewing seams, or preparing parts)?
3. What is the *last* general step in sewing a shirt?
4. When is the sleeve "set in" (attached)? Is it *before* or *after* the side seams are sewn?
5. Why is it easier to attach a pocket *before* the side seams are sewn?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write out the 8-step "Order of Construction" for a simple shirt.

2. Research "Set-in Sleeve" vs. "Raglan Sleeve." Draw a simple diagram of what each *pattern piece* looks like.
3. Write a 150-word report on the "Ease" in a sleeve cap. What is it, and why is it necessary?
4. Define: Placket, Interfacing, Topstitching, Set-in Sleeve, Easing.
5. Why do you sew *buttonholes* first, and *buttons* second?



WEEK 10: PRACTICAL: SEWING A SIMPLE GARMENT

TOPIC: GARMENT CONSTRUCTION (PROJECT)

INTRODUCTION



This week is a **synthesis project**. The goal is to combine *all* the skills you have learned in the first and second terms into a single, finished, practical item.

This project will test your ability to:

- **Measure & Cut** accurately (1st Term, Wk 3)
- **Use the Sewing Machine** safely (1st Term, Wk 4 & Wk 6)

- **Sew Straight Stitches** (2nd Term, Wk 3)
- **Sew Seams** (2nd Term, Wk 4)
- **Apply Seam Finishes** (2nd Term, Wk 4)
- **Create Hems** (2nd Term, Wk 2)
- **Press correctly** (2nd Term, Wk 9)

PROJECT 1: HANDKERCHIEF (OR TABLE NAPKIN)

- **Objective:** To practice precision cutting and perfect hemming (by hand or machine).
- **Skills:** Measuring, Cutting, Pressing, Hemming (Slant Stitch or Machine).
- **Materials:** A 30cm x 30cm square of lightweight cotton or chiffon.
- **Process:**
 - a. **Measure & Cut:** Carefully measure and cut a *perfect* 30cm x 30cm square. Use your Tailor's Square to ensure 90-degree corners.
 - b. **Press Hem:** On one edge, fold the raw edge in 0.5cm and press. Fold it 0.5cm *again* (this is a **double-fold hem**) and press. This encloses the raw edge.
 - c. **Miter Corners:** (Advanced) At the corners, fold the fabric diagonally to create a "miter" for a flat, sharp corner.
 - d. **Press** all four sides.
 - e. **Sew:** Secure the hem.
 - **Machine:** "Topstitch" the hem with a straight stitch, sewing very close (1-2mm) to the inner folded edge.
 - **Hand:** Use a **Slant Hemming Stitch** (from Wk 2) for an invisible, high-quality finish.
 - f. **Final Press:** Give the entire handkerchief a final press.

PROJECT 2: SIMPLE PILLOWCASE (BAG STYLE)

- **Objective:** To practice sewing straight seams and applying seam finishes.
- **Skills:** Measuring, Cutting, Plain Seam, Seam Finish (Zigzag or French).

- **Materials:** A large rectangle of cotton or poly-cotton (e.g., 55cm x 110cm for a standard pillow).
- **Process:**
 - a. **Measure & Cut:** Cut the fabric to the correct dimensions.
 - b. **Sew the Hem:** Take *one* of the short (55cm) edges. Create a deep **double-fold hem** (e.g., fold 1cm, press; fold 3cm, press). This will be the "opening" of the pillowcase.
 - c. **Machine Stitch** the hem down.
 - d. **Sew the Seam:** Fold the *entire* piece of fabric in half, **Right Sides Together (RST)**, matching the hemmed edge.
 - e. **Machine Stitch a Plain Seam** along the *bottom* edge and the *side* edge (the two raw edges). Backstitch at the start and end.
 - f. **Finish the Seam:** You now have two raw seam allowances on the *inside* of the pillowcase. They will fray if you don't finish them.
 - **Option A (Zigzag):** Set your machine to a zigzag stitch and sew along the raw edge of both seam allowances.
 - **Option B (French Seam):** If you are using a lightweight fabric, you could use a French Seam (from Wk 4) for a superior, enclosed finish.
 - g. **Final Step:** Turn the pillowcase right-side-out and give it a final press.

PROJECT 3: SIMPLE BIB APRON

- **Objective:** To practice using a simple pattern, sewing curves, and creating/attaching straps.
- **Skills:** Pattern use, cutting, hemming, creating straps, applying fullness (optional).
- **Materials:** 1 meter of sturdy cotton, drill, or "Ankara" fabric.
- **Process:**
 - a. **Pattern:** Draft or use a simple pattern for the main apron "bib."
 - b. **Cut:** Cut 1 x Bib Body. Cut 3 x long strips (e.g., 8cm wide) for the ties (2 for the waist, 1 for the neck loop).

- c. **Hem Bib:** Sew a double-fold hem around the *curved* armhole edges and the *sides* of the bib.
- d. **Create Straps:**
- Fold one long strip in half (RST).
 - Sew a 1cm seam along the long edge.
 - Turn the tube right-side-out (a difficult but important skill).
 - Press the strap flat.
 - Repeat for all 3 straps.
- e. **Attach Straps:**
- Fold the raw ends of the neck strap and topstitch it to the top two corners of the bib.
 - Fold the raw ends of the waist straps and topstitch them securely to the side "waist" corners.
- f. **Final Press:** Press the entire apron.

EVALUATION

1. What is a "double-fold hem," and what is its purpose?
2. For the pillowcase project, why is it important to apply a seam finish to the *inside* seams?
3. Which project is the best for practicing a "French Seam"?
4. What is the most challenging part of making the straps for the apron?
5. What two skills from previous lessons are required to make the apron?

ASSIGNMENT

1. **PRACTICAL:** You *must* make **one** of the three projects (Handkerchief, Pillowcase, or Apron).
2. **DOCUMENTATION:** Submit your finished project.
3. **WRITTEN:** Write a one-page "Production Report" for your project. Your report must include:
 - (a) A list of all materials and tools you used.

- (b) The step-by-step process you followed.
 - (c) A list of all the *skills* you used (e.g., "measuring," "cutting," "plain seam," "hemming").
 - (d) A "self-evaluation": What part was most successful? What part was most difficult?
4. Calculate the total fabric needed for a pillowcase that must finish at 50cm x 70cm. (You will need to add seam allowances and a hem allowance).
 5. Draw the pattern pieces you would need for the simple bib apron (1 bib, 3 straps).



WEEK 11-13: REVISION & EXAMS

REVISION OF ALL SECOND TERM TOPICS

This period is for a comprehensive review of all practical skills and theory covered this term.

- **WEEK 1: TEMPORARY STITCHES**

- **Purpose:** Fitting, guiding, holding.
- **Types:** Even Tacking, Uneven Tacking, Diagonal Tacking, **Tailor's Tacks** (for marking).

- **WEEK 2: PERMANENT HAND STITCHES**

- **Running Stitch:** Simple, for mending/gathering.
- **Backstitch:** Strongest hand stitch (mimics machine).
- **Hemming Stitches:** Slant/Slip (invisible), Blind (most invisible).
- **Oversewing:** Joining finished edges.

- **WEEK 3: MACHINE STITCHES**

- **Lockstitch:** Top thread + Bobbin thread.
- **Straight Stitch:** For seams (Width 0, Length 2.5-3).
- **Zigzag Stitch:** For seam finishes and stretch fabrics (Width 1-5).
- **Tension:** The key to a balanced stitch.

- **WEEK 4: SEAMS & SEAM FINISHES**

- **Plain Seam:** Sewn RST. Must be *finished*.
- **French Seam:** Sewn WST, then RST. *Enclosed seam* for delicate fabrics.
- **Finishes:** Overlocked (pro), Zigzag (home), Pinking (weak).

- **WEEK 6 & 8: FULLNESS TECHNIQUES**

- **Darts:** V-shape to *remove* fabric for 3D shaping (bust, waist).
- **Tucks:** Stitched *folds* (often decorative).
- **Gathers:** Drawing up fabric with *2 lines of long stitches*.
- **Pleats:** *Folded* fullness, stitched at the top (Knife, Box, Inverted).

- **Smocking:** *Embroidery* over gathers.
- **Shirring:** Using *elastic thread* in the bobbin.
- **WEEK 9: PRESSING**
 - **Pressing vs. Ironing:** "Up-and-Down" (pressing) vs. "Back-and-Forth" (ironing).
 - **Pressing Cloth:** Prevents shine and melting.
 - **Tailor's Ham:** For pressing curves (darts, hips).
 - **Seam Roll:** For pressing tube seams (sleeves, trousers).
- **WEEK 10: PRACTICALS**
 - We combined all skills to make a simple, finished article.

FINAL EXAMINATION

The final examination will consist of two parts:

1. **Theory Paper (40%):** Definitions, short-answer questions, "describe the process" questions (e.g., "How do you sew a French Seam?"), and scenario questions (e.g., "What fullness technique is best for a stretchy dress?").
2. **Practical Exam (60%):** A timed test where you will be given fabric and instructions to perform specific tasks, such as:
 - Sew a plain seam with a zigzag finish.
 - Sew a French seam.
 - Sew a dart.
 - Sew a set of gathers.